CAMPAIGN OS | SWING SHACK, STICK AND THE BAG DROP

Brand Bibles

How each brand writes, what it will and will not say, and the standard every caption is held to.

Stick

Paarl. Fitting, workshop and modern golf retail. Smart Rebel, expressed as calm precision.

Swing Shack

Johannesburg. The indoor golf club. The sharp coach who is also a great host.

The Bag Drop

Online. Demo and pre-owned golf gear, honestly graded. Dry, plain, curated.

A The Language Standard | B The Gate | C Stick | D Swing Shack | E The Bag Drop

Status: draft for owner review. Every setting is proposed from the real feeds and the owners' own documents. Each bible lists the decisions that only the owners can make, and nothing is final until they are answered.

Prepared 15 October 2026 | Source branch docs/brand-bible-template, commit 15c11897, with the Swing Shack visual identity updated from the designer's branding document

How to read these bibles

What this is. One brand bible each for Stick, Swing Shack and The Bag Drop, plus the two shared chapters every brand answers to: the **Language Standard** (chapter A) and the **Gate** (chapter B). Each brand bible was written from the brand's own Instagram feed (Stick: 258 captions; Swing Shack: 764; The Bag Drop: 33), the owners' strategy and bible documents, and the live websites. Counts were taken on 13 October 2026.

Start with the decisions. Every brand chapter opens with the findings that matter most and a table of decisions only the owners can make. Nothing in a bible is confirmed until those are answered.

CONFIRMED	DRAFT	UNKNOWN
The owner said yes, or a named source says so.	Proposed from the feed or the strategy. Usable, but check it before relying on it.	Nobody knows yet. Treated as "do not say it".

When rules disagree

1. The law and platform terms.
2. Verified facts in the Proof bank (section 7). A fact beats a nice line.
3. Chapter A, the Language Standard.
4. The brand's own the brand bible settings.
5. The measured feed (section 16). It informs the bible. It never overrides rules 1 to 4.
6. A campaign brief. A brief may change what is said, never how well it is written.

Where the Language Standard says "section 2" or "section 7", it means that section of the brand's own bible (chapters C to E).

What is not in this PDF

The machine-readable rules block at the end of each bible (the settings the caption linter reads) and the blank bible form are in the repository, on the branch `docs/brand-bible-template`. They are left out here because they are for the tools, not for reading.

> **Figures change.** Prices, stock, follower counts and product counts on the live store move daily. Every figure here is dated. Re-count before quoting one.

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CHAPTER A

The Language Standard

The rules of written English, tone and manners. They apply to every brand.

The principal's rules. Imagine the head of a very good school reading your caption over your shoulder. Not a stern one. A fair one, who notices everything and will not let a sloppy line through because it was posted in a hurry. Every rule has an ID so a reviewer can write "fails L5.6" instead of "feels off".

L1. Spelling and language

- **L1.1** One language variant per brand, recorded in section 2. Never mix variants in a post. The default for South African brands is South African English, which follows British spelling: colour, centre, programme, tyre, practise (verb), licence (noun), `-ise` endings.
- **L1.2** Names are spelled exactly as the registry in section 3 spells them. Brand, product, person, venue, partner, handle. `TrackMan`, never `Trackman`. If a name is not in the registry, find out how its owner writes it before using it.
- **L1.3** No typos, ever. Read every post once more after the last edit, because the last edit is where typos live.
- **L1.4** No text-speak: no `u`, `ur`, `4` for for, `gonna`, `wanna`, `lol`. A quoted customer is the only exception, and the quote must be real and permitted.
- **L1.5** No invented words, no pun that needs a footnote, no deliberate misspelling for style, unless the brand registry lists it as a signature.

L2. Grammar and punctuation

- **L2.1** Full sentences. A fragment is allowed only on purpose: one per post at most, and it must be doing a job (a hook, a sign-off). A fragment by accident is a mistake.
- **L2.2 No em dashes and no en dashes in running copy.** Use a full stop, a colon, a comma or a pipe. Ranges are written with "to" (10 to 15) or a plain hyphen between numerals. This is already the rule on every brand in this repo.
- **L2.3** Apostrophes: `it's` is "it is", `its` is possession. Plurals never take an apostrophe (iron sets, not iron's). Use one apostrophe style throughout a post.
- **L2.4** Exclamation marks follow the cap in section 2. The default is none in headlines, one at most per post, and only for a real occasion. Two in a row is never right.
- **L2.5** Ellipses are not used for suspense or trailing off. Three dots at the end of a line mean the writer ran out of idea.
- **L2.6** Capitalisation: sentence case for headlines and captions. Proper nouns are capitalised. ALL CAPS only where a template defines a label, and never more than three words in running text. No Random Title Case. No capital letters for emphasis.
- **L2.7** The serial comma follows the brand setting. Whichever is chosen is used every time.
- **L2.8** Lists are parallel: every item starts the same way (all verbs, or all nouns). Do not mix "Book a bay" with "Coaching" in the same list.
- **L2.9** One space after a full stop. No double spaces, no trailing spaces, no stray blank lines at the end, no line breaks in the middle of a sentence unless it is a designed line break.
- **L2.10** Quotation marks follow the brand setting (single or double), and punctuation goes where the brand's style puts it. Never quote a customer or an expert without permission and a source.
- **L2.11** Abbreviations: spell out on first use unless the audience says it daily. No abbreviation that is only common inside the team.

L3. Numbers, units, money, dates, times

- **L3.1** Numerals for data (carry 145, 4 bays, 30 minutes). Words for one to nine in plain prose. Never start a sentence with a numeral.
- **L3.2** Currency format follows section 2 and matches the booking engine and website. Never write a price in two formats in one post.
- **L3.3** One unit system per post, never mixed (yards or metres, not both). A figure always carries its unit.
- **L3.4** Dates and times follow section 2. A date without a year is acceptable only inside the current year. "This Saturday" is allowed in a caption only if the post goes out that week. Evergreen copy never uses relative time.
- **L3.5** Every number comes from the Proof bank (section 7) with a source and a date. No rounding up to flatter. No "up to" used to hide the typical case. No number that looks like a TrackMan or fitting result unless it is a real, permitted one.

L4. Claims and truth

- **L4.1** If it is not in the Proof bank, do not say it. Prices, hours, stock, brands carried, offers, awards, counts, "first", "only", "best". `UNKNOWN` means silent.
- **L4.2** Superlatives and comparatives need evidence a stranger could check. "Premium", "world-class" and "leading" are not evidence.
- **L4.3** An offer states four things: what it is, who it is for, when it ends, how to claim it. Missing any of the four is an unfinished offer.
- **L4.4** Competitors are never named in a negative light. Fair comparison on a fact is allowed only with a source and approver sign-off.
- **L4.5** Partner and supplier names are written the way the partner writes them. Tagging a partner follows the permission rule in section 3.
- **L4.6** People in images and quotes: consent is on file, or it is not published.
- **L4.7** Required legal or ad-policy copy is added by the template or the ad setup, never left to the writer's memory.

L5. Caption anatomy

A caption is built, not poured. The parts, in order:

1. **Hook** : line one. It must stand on its own and make sense with the image hidden.
2. **Body** : one idea, one or two short paragraphs.
3. **Proof or detail** : the fact that makes the idea believable (from the Proof bank).
4. **Call to action** : one, exactly.
5. **Sign-off** : only if the brand has a house sign-off (section 6).
6. **Tags** : hashtags and mentions, last.

- **L5.1** The hook is not the brand name, not "We", not a greeting ("Happy Monday"), not a question the reader can answer "no" to and scroll on. It opens on the subject, the fact, the tension or the reader. Maximum length is the brand setting in section 2, set so the whole hook shows before the platform's "more". Check the current platform cut-off rather than trusting a remembered number.
- **L5.2** One idea per caption. Two ideas make two posts.
- **L5.3** Length stays inside the band for the lane (section 8). Short is not a virtue by itself. Right-sized is.
- **L5.4** Short paragraphs: one or two sentences, a blank line between blocks, no block longer than three lines on a phone. A wall of text is a defect.

- **L5.5** The caption adds what the image cannot. It never repeats the on-image text word for word. If the image says it, the caption goes further or goes quiet.
- **L5.6** Exactly one call to action. It starts with a verb. It is taken from the brand's approved list in section 6 and tells the reader precisely how ("DM us", "link in bio", a URL). Two CTAs split the reader. Zero CTAs waste the post, unless the lane is declared "no CTA" in section 8.
- **L5.7** The house sign-off, if there is one, is the last line before tags, spelled exactly, and never appears mid-caption.
- **L5.8** Hashtags follow the section 2 budget: count, placement, CamelCase for multi-word tags (`#GolfFitting` , not `#golffitting`), brand tags first. None in stories text. A hashtag never replaces a word in a sentence.
- **L5.9** Emoji follow the budget and the allowed list in section 2. Never as a bullet, never in place of a word, never in the hook unless the brand allows it, never a cluster.
- **L5.10** Mentions use verified handles, spelled and capitalised as the account has them. Tag only when the registry says tagging is welcome.
- **L5.11** Links: Instagram captions do not carry live links, so they say "link in bio". Where a URL is shown, it is complete, correct, lowercase, without tracking junk.
- **L5.12** Alt text is a plain, literal description of what is in the image, written for someone who cannot see it. No keyword stuffing. No "image of".
- **L5.13** On-image headlines stay inside the template's limit (section 14) and read correctly without the caption.

L6. Register and manners

- **L6.1 Precision over adjectives.** Every sentence carries a fact, a feeling or an action. If deleting it loses nothing, delete it.
- **L6.2 The swap test.** Replace the brand name with a competitor's. If the line still works, it says nothing. Rewrite it with something only this brand can say.
- **L6.3** Plain words. Choose the shorter word. Write so a sharp 14-year-old can follow the sentence the first time. Jargon is used only if the audience uses it, and is explained the first time with the plain conclusion beside it.
- **L6.4** Active voice, present tense, second person. "You" is the reader. "We" is used only for something the team actually does, never for "our passion" or "our commitment".
- **L6.5** Confident, not loud. State it. No hedging (just, maybe, kind of, we think). No shouting (amazing, incredible, insane).
- **L6.6** Respect the reader. Never mock the player's ability. Humour is shared, never aimed. No guilt, no shaming, no fear used as a lever.
- **L6.7** Manners: a plain "please" and "thank you" where they are earned. Replies address the person, not the post.
- **L6.8** Same voice across a lane. The voice dial settings in section 5 do not drift from post to post. Tone moves with the situation (section 5), never with the writer's mood.
- **L6.9 Read it aloud.** If you stumble, the reader will. Rewrite until it comes out clean.
- **L6.10** Say it once. No repeated word within a sentence unless it is deliberate, and no restating the hook in the closing line.

L7. Banned patterns (every brand)

These are the fingerprints of lazy or machine-written copy. A brand may add to this list in section 6, never remove from it.

Empty words and phrases

`unlock`, `elevate`, `level up`, `next level`, `game changer`, `game-changing`, `journey` (as a metaphor), `seamless`, `curated`, `tailored solutions`, `bespoke` (unless literally made to order), `state-of-the-art`, `world-class`, `premium experience`, `cutting-edge`, `passionate about`, `your one-stop`, `look no further`, `we've got you covered`, `take your game to the next level`, `delve`, `dive into`, `in today's fast-paced world`, `whether you're a ... or a ...`, `crushing it`, `beast mode`

Filler openers and closers

`Ready to...?`, `Looking to...?`, `Imagine...`, `Picture this`, `Calling all golfers`, `Exciting news`, `We are thrilled / delighted / excited to announce`, `Say hello to`, `Introducing`, `Happy [day]!`, `Stay tuned`, `Don't miss out`, `Hit us up`, `Link below` (when it is in the bio), `Let that sink in`

Engagement bait

`Tag a friend who...`, `Comment YES if...`, `Like if you agree`, `Double tap`, `Share with someone who...`, giveaways that are really follower farming

Structures

- "It's not just X, it's Y." and every cousin of it.
- Three adjectives in a row. Three parallel clauses used only for rhythm.
- A question the caption never answers.
- A colon-and-list "listicle" voice in a caption that should be a sentence.
- Punchy one-word paragraphs stacked for drama.
- Self-congratulation: telling the reader the product is great instead of showing why.
- Anything that sounds like a hotel brochure, a corporate About page or a press release.

Always wrong

Em dashes. Double exclamation marks. All-caps sentences. A hashtag wall. An emoji sandwich. A caption that is only a tagline. A caption that is only a hashtag.

L8. The twelve ways a caption looks bad

The reviewer's quick scan. Each points at the rule that cures it.

#	Defect	Cure
1	Wall of text	L5.4
2	Hashtag dump	L5.8
3	Emoji clutter	L5.9, L2.4
4	Vague superlatives, nothing specific	L4.2, L6.1, L6.2
5	Wrong or inconsistent name spelling	L1.2
6	Hook buried or cut off by "more"	L5.1
7	Missing, doubled or vague CTA	L5.6
8	A fact that is not true or not verified	L3.5, L4.1
9	Tone swings inside one post	L6.8
10	Caption repeats the image text	L5.5
11	Capital letters and punctuation used for volume	L2.4, L2.6
12	Reads like an ad written by nobody	L6.2, L7

L9. The red pen: before and after

Placeholders in `[brackets]` stand for verified facts from the Proof bank. These show structure, not real claims.

Before	After	Fixed
Unlock your full potential with our state-of-the-art fitting experience!	Your driver is [loft, shaft]. Your swing is [speed]. Let's see if they agree. Book a fitting.	L7, L2.4, L6.2, L5.6
We're so excited to announce our brand new [product] has arrived!!!	The [product] has arrived. [One real detail]. Message us to see it.	L7, L2.4, L6.1
Looking to improve your game? Our expert coaches are passionate about helping you!	[Specific problem] has a cause, and it is usually [cause]. A [duration] lesson finds it. Book coaching.	L7, L6.2, L5.1
Did you know — most golfers play the wrong shafts??	[Verified statistic or observation], and the fix takes [duration]. Book a fitting.	L2.2, L2.4, L4.1
Happy Friday golfers! Here's our weekend special 🔥 🔥 🔥 #golf #golfing #golflife #golfer	[Offer]: [what], for [who], until [date]. DM us to claim it. #GolfFitting	L7, L4.3, L5.8, L5.9

CHAPTER B

The Gate

What every caption, headline and reply runs through before it ships.

Everything runs through it. Captions, headlines, ad copy, stories, reel scripts and on-screen text, replies, emails, alt text, image briefs, template fields.

Step 1. Set the context

Write these four lines first. If you cannot, stop and find out.

```
Brand:   ______   Lane: ______   Channel: ______   Asset: ______
```

Step 2. Load only what applies

Asset	Load
Caption	Chapter A in full; sections 2, 3, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9
Headline or on-image text	L1, L2, L3, L4, L6, L7; sections 2, 3, 6, 14
Story frame	L1, L2, L6, L7; sections 2, 3, 5, 6, 9
Reel script and on-screen text	Chapter A; sections 2, 3, 5, 6, 7, 9
Paid ad copy	Chapter A in full; sections 2, 3, 5, 6, 7, 9; platform ad policy
Reply, DM, review response	L1, L2, L6, L7; sections 3, 5.3, 6, 10
Email, WhatsApp, SMS	Chapter A; sections 2, 3, 5, 6, 7, 9
Alt text	L1, L2, L5.12; section 3
Image or video brief	Sections 11, 12, 13, 14; L4.6

Step 3. Write, then check

Write the draft. Then run the checks in this order, because the cheap ones catch the most.

Hard fails. Any one means rewrite, no score.

Check	Rule
A fact, number, price, offer or claim not in the Proof bank	L3.5, L4.1
A name misspelled or a partner used without permission	L1.2, L4.5
An em dash or en dash	L2.2
A banned word or pattern from L7 or the brand list	L7
More than one CTA, or a CTA outside the approved list	L5.6

Check	Rule
Typo, text-speak or wrong language variant	L1
Exclamation marks over the cap	L2.4
Hook over the character limit, or hook is a greeting or the brand name	L5.1
Copy over the template's declared limit	section 14
A person, product or place shown that is not real or not cleared	L4.6, section 12
Offer missing any of what, who, when, how	L4.3

Scored checks. Score each 0, 1 or 2.

0 = fails, 1 = acceptable, 2 = good enough to use as an example.

#	Dimension	What a 2 looks like
1	Hook	Stands alone, specific, earns the second line
2	One idea	Nothing in the caption could be its own post
3	Specificity	Passes the swap test (L6.2)
4	Anatomy	Parts in order, lengths in the lane's band
5	Voice	Matches the dial settings and the situation row
6	Plain English	Reads cleanly aloud, shortest word each time
7	Layout	Short paragraphs, no wall, tags last and few
8	CTA	Verb first, exact how, matches the lane

Pass: 12 or more out of 16, with no 0. Anything below 12, or with a 0, is rewritten.

Step 4. Fix and log

Rewrite once, citing the rule IDs, then run the checks again. If it fails a second time, the problem is the brief, not the wording: go back to the lane, the proof or the idea.

Step 5. Record

```
GATE RESULT
Brand / lane / channel / asset:
Hard fails:       none | list rule IDs
Score:            _ / 16   (hook _, idea _, specific _, anatomy _, voice _, plain _, layout _, CTA _)
Facts used:       list Proof bank rows
Rules cited in fixes:
Reviewer / date:
Approver (if the lane requires one):
```

Worked example

Brand and lane: a retail-and-service golf brand, product arrival, Instagram feed.

Draft:

> 🔥 Exciting news golfers!!! We're thrilled to announce our brand new [Brand] irons are finally here — and they are a total game changer for your game! Come check them out and unlock your full potential 🏌️ Tag a friend who needs new irons! #golf #irons
>
> # golfclubs #golfer #golflife #newgear #golfaddict

Gate:

Check	Result
Hard fail: em dash	yes (L2.2)
Hard fail: banned patterns	"Exciting news", "thrilled to announce", "game changer", "unlock your full potential", "Tag a friend" (L7)
Hard fail: exclamation over cap	three in a row (L2.4)
Hard fail: hook	opens on "Exciting news", a filler opener, then greets the reader (L5.1)
Hard fail: CTA	two CTAs, neither says how (L5.6)
Hard fail: facts	no model, no price, no stock confirmation (L4.1)
Score	would be capped at 0 on hook, specificity, CTA

Rewrite (facts shown as placeholders; every one must come from the Proof bank):

> The [Brand] [model] irons are in stock at [location].
>
> [One true detail the golfer cares about.] [Who they suit.]
>
> DM us to book a fitting before you buy.
>
> [Sign-off if the brand has one]
>
> # [BrandTag] #[LocationTag]

Hook states the news and the place. One idea. Facts are verifiable. One CTA with its how. Two hashtags in CamelCase. No banned pattern. Score 13 to 15 once the placeholders are real.

CHAPTER C

Stick

Brand bible, draft 1

Written 2026-10-13 from: the Stick Brand Bible Draft v3 (`bible-source.txt`), the Brand and Commercial Strategy 2026 to 2029 (`strategy-source.txt`), the workbook's Stick sections (`swing-shack/workbook-source.txt`), `knowledge.json` (verified 2026-09-23), and all 261 posts in `feedback/instagram-audit.json` (10 March to 5 October 2026, account `stick.paarl`). Every count in this file was re-run from that audit on 2026-10-13.

Status: `DRAFT` . Nothing here is `CONFIRMED` unless a source is named beside it. The approvers have not yet signed it.

Decisions needed before this can be marked CONFIRMED

These are the places where the sources disagree, or where only the owners can decide. Each has a recommendation and the evidence for it.

#	Decision	Recommendation	Evidence
1	**The voice.** The bible says "sharp, confident, direct, smart, rebellious". The old `voice/` files say "sarcastic, meme-aware". The feed reads calm and plain.	Keep "Smart Rebel" as the character. Express it as calm precision and dry understatement, never sarcasm.	Workbook D and bible section 16 say the edge "must feel like confidence, not resentment". The September posts already do this. Section 5.
2	**Sign-off spelling.** Bible and workbook: "Better Begins Here". Feed: "Better begins here."	Captions end with `Better begins here.` (sentence case, full stop). Title case or caps stays on artwork and lock-ups.	116 of 136 closing lines are exactly `Better begins here.` Only 3 use title case.
3	**How the name is written in a sentence.**	`Stick` in running copy. `STICK` only on artwork and the logo.	The feed uses `Stick` 126 times, `stick` 37 times, `STICK` 34 times.
4	**Emoji.** Used on 26 captions, almost all in April. None since July except two.	None by default. 📍 allowed on an address line.	Emoji by month: April 18, May 4, July 2, August 2, September 0.
5	**Hashtags.**	Zero to five, at the end, CamelCase. The feed's five tags are lowercase today.	Hashtags appear on 5 captions, all in June and September, always five.
6	**Discounts and "tag a mate" giveaways.**	Retired. The bible says Stick "does not do discount theatre".	14 of 59 March captions used a percentage-off line. None since April.
7	**Currency format.**	`R7,999` (matches the feed). Check the website and booking page before confirming.	The one price in the feed is `R7,999` .
8	**Distance units.**	Metres for carry, yards only if the TrackMan screen in shot shows yards. Never mixed.	Workbook example uses "15 metres". The feed uses a "150 marker" once. Needs the owners.
9	**Instagram handle.**	`stick.paarl` until proven otherwise.	Workbook O says `@stickgolf` . All 261 audited posts come from `stick.paarl` . `stickgolf` appears only in the web address and the `work@` email.
10	**Real customer names and build data in public posts.**	Written consent on file before any named customer.	The Rush Naidoo build post ran twice on 12 June with different spellings of the name. No consent record is in the repo.

#	Decision	Recommendation	Evidence
11	**Mentioning Swing Shack.**	Banned in copy unless the approver says yes in the current message.	Old README calls Stick a "sub-brand". `knowledge.json` and bible section 1 say sister brand under Stick Golf Group. The old README is wrong.
12	**Opening hours, phone, WhatsApp.**	Supply them. They are `UNKNOWN`, so they cannot appear in copy.	Not in any source file.
13	**Partner brand spellings** (Ripit, L.A.B., Avoda, Sub 70).	Confirm from each supplier's own materials.	Feed spells Ripit as `Ripit`, `RIPIT` and `Ripit`; `knowledge.json` has `RipIt`.
14	**Approvers.**	Hermanus Kriel and Dave Lamprecht (co-owners, per workbook A).	Workbook lists both. `@lampsdave` in the feed appears to be Dave. Unconfirmed.

0. Document control

Field	Value	Status
Brand	Stick	**CONFIRMED** (workbook A)
Bible version	Template v1, Stick draft 1, 2026-10-13	**DRAFT**
Owner (writes and maintains)	Christelle (marketing)	**DRAFT**
Approver (signs changes)	Hermanus Kriel and Dave Lamprecht	**DRAFT** (workbook A; see decision 14)
Next review	2027-01-13 (90 days), and after any rebrand	**DRAFT**
Sources	See header. Feed counts from `feedback/instagram-audit.json`, generated 2026-10-05T14:22:33Z	**CONFIRMED**

Section status: 0 to 3 DRAFT · 4 CONFIRMED (from bible and strategy) · 5 DRAFT · 6 DRAFT · 7 mixed, row by row · 8 DRAFT · 9 DRAFT · 10 DRAFT · 11 DRAFT, colours unconfirmed (see section 11) · 12 and 13 CONFIRMED (workbook G, H) · 14 DRAFT · 15 DRAFT · 16 CONFIRMED (counted) · 17 DRAFT.

1. Snapshot

Field	Value	Status
Trading name	STICK (wordmark) / Stick (running text)	**DRAFT** (decision 3)
Website	stickgolf.co.za	**CONFIRMED** (workbook A)
Booking page	stickgolf.co.za/bookings/	**CONFIRMED** 2026-09-23 (`knowledge.json`); re-check before use
Location	Paarl, Western Cape. "Paarl is the home; the Western Cape is the market."	**CONFIRMED** (strategy section 4)
Address	Winelands Square, corner R101 and Sandwyk Street, Paarl, 7646	**DRAFT** (from launch posts 2 and 7 April; the posts spell it "Shopping Center" with a stray comma, confirm the venue's own spelling)
Opened	1 May 2026. Launch event 29 April 2026, 15:00 to 18:00	**DRAFT** (from the feed)

Field	Value	Status
What it is, literally	A modern golf performance retailer and culture brand: fitting, coaching, workshop, equipment and apparel under one roof. "Part fitting studio, part workshop, part modern golf retailer, part editor."	**CONFIRMED** (bible section 8, strategy)
What it is not	Not a traditional golf shop. Not a country-club extension. Not a simulator bar pretending to be serious. Not a sub-brand of Swing Shack.	**CONFIRMED** (bible section 1)
Customer actions	Get fitted. Buy better equipment. Improve through coaching. Discover curated products.	**CONFIRMED** (workbook A)
Instagram	`stick.paarl`	**DRAFT** (decision 9)
Other channels	Facebook, Google Business Profile. TikTok not a priority.	**CONFIRMED** (workbook L, O)
Sister brand	Swing Shack, under Stick Golf Group. Not named in Stick copy.	**CONFIRMED** (`knowledge.json`)

2. Language settings

Each setting is chosen from what the feed already does, then checked against the rules. "Feed" shows the evidence. Nothing here changes how the brand sounds; it removes the inconsistencies that make captions look careless.

Setting	Decision	Feed evidence	Status
Language variant (L1.1)	South African English, British spelling	Copy-pasted supplier text on 20 June uses "Optimized". Everything Stick wrote itself uses "centre", "colour", "metres"	**DRAFT**
Serial comma (L2.7)	No	"Speed, forgiveness and a shape that does not mess about" and similar	**DRAFT**
Quotation marks (L2.10)	Double, curly	Double curly in the dictionary posts and the "Better begins here" comment prompt	**DRAFT**
Apostrophes (L2.3)	Curly	49 captions curly, 7 straight	**DRAFT**
Exclamation marks (L2.4)	0 in headlines. Max 1 per post, only for a real event	4 captions in 258, all "Know your swing!" pre-launch	**DRAFT**
Em and en dashes (L2.2)	Never	2 captions contain an em dash (22 and 28 May). 0 en dashes	**CONFIRMED** rule
Ellipses (L2.5)	Never	0 in the feed	**CONFIRMED**
Number style (L3.1)	Numerals for data and money. Words one to nine in prose	"30-minute", "25 minutes", "Only two available", "Three matching headcovers"	**DRAFT**
Currency (L3.2)	`R7,999`	One price in the feed	**DRAFT** (decision 7)
Units (L3.3)	Metres	Workbook example "15 metres"	**DRAFT** (decision 8)
Dates (L3.4)	`29 April 2026` . No ordinals (`1 May` , never `1st May`)	"Opening 1 May" 10 times; "Opening 1st May" once	**DRAFT**
Times (L3.4)	24-hour, ranges with "to": `15:00 to 18:00`	Feed uses `15:00-18:00`	**DRAFT**
Hook maximum (L5.1)	80 characters, then re-check against the live Instagram cut-off	Median first line 25 characters, 90th percentile 52. September first lines run longer	**DRAFT**

Setting	Decision	Feed evidence	Status
Hashtags (L5.8)	0 to 5, last, CamelCase, brand set only	See decision 5	DRAFT
Allowed hashtags	`#PaarlGolf` `#WesternCapeGolf` `#GolfersOfSouthAfrica` `#GolfClubFitting` `#CustomGolfClubs` `#GolfCoaching` `#GolfBags` `#GolfTips`	Eight of the ten tags the feed has used. `#golfaccessories` and `#newirons` dropped as too generic	DRAFT
Emoji (L5.9)	None. 📍 allowed on an address line	See decision 4	DRAFT
Caps (L2.6)	Sentence case. `TrackMan` , `L.A.B.` , `AVODA` as the owners write them	Feed uses all caps for `AVODA` and `RIPIT` inconsistently	DRAFT
Sign-off (L5.7)	`Better begins here.` as the last line of the caption, before credits and tags	See decision 2	DRAFT
Photo credit line	`Photo credit: @handle` after the sign-off, only when a photographer is owed	9 captions end on `Photo Credit: @shante.hutton.photography`	DRAFT
Contact line	One CTA line, see section 6		DRAFT

3. Name registry

Exact spelling. Wrong spellings are in the last column so a linter can flag them.

Name	Write it as	Known wrong forms (seen in feed)	Notes
This brand	`Stick` in sentences. `STICK` on artwork	`stick` (37 captions), `STICK` mid-sentence	Decision 3
Tagline	`Better begins here.`	`Better Begins Here.` , `Better begins here` (no stop), `Better begins today.` (6 Aug), `Better golf starts here.`	`Better golf starts here.` is a different line and must not open a caption that also ends on the tagline. Three captions did exactly that (24, 26 and 28 April)
Fitting technology	`TrackMan`	None found	Never as the headline. "The tool is not personality" (workbook N)
Psycho Bunny	`Psycho Bunny`	`Psychobunny` (9 April)	11 captions use the right form
Takomo	`Takomo`		Valid models: Iron 101, 101T, 101 MKII, 201, 201 MKII, 201T MKII, 301 CB, 301 MB, 301 Combo. **Do not use** 101T-CB, 101T-MB, 201T, 101T Pro (quarantined in `knowledge.json`)
Vice	`Vice Golf` first mention, `Vice` after	`Vice Golf @ Stick` (double space)	
L.A.B.	`L.A.B. Golf`	`L.A.B @ Stick`	Confirm with supplier
Avoda	`Avoda`		Artwork uses caps. Confirm with supplier
Vessel	`Vessel`		
Ripit (grips)	UNKNOWN	`Ripit` (4), `RIPIT` (2), `RipIt` in `knowledge.json`	Confirm with supplier before writing again
Mileseey	`Mileseey`		Order-in, not stocked: "available through Stick"
Sub 70	`Sub 70`		Fitting only, per the feed

Name	Write it as	Known wrong forms (seen in feed)	Notes
Other brands seen in the feed	Titleist, Scotty Cameron, Srixon, Jordan, Callaway, Fujimoto, Miura, Sausage Putters		Stock status `UNKNOWN`. Check before any product post
Stick's own product	`Stick Bag Freshener`		
People	Jared (club fitter). Dave Lamprecht (co-owner and fitter, handle `@lampsdave`). Blake Sutherland (coach, `@blake.sutherland.golf`). Shante Hutton (photographer, `@shante.hutton.photography`)		Surname for Jared `UNKNOWN`. May be named in posts only with their consent
Place	`Winelands Square, Paarl`	`Shopping Center`, `Sandwyk St`	Spell out "Street" in running copy
Terms	`club assessment`, `club fitting`, `ball fitting`, `fitter`, `workshop`		One term per thing
Properties	`Why it's here`, `Fit first. Buy second.`, `Built at Stick`, `Ask Stick`, `Style that belongs`, `Product drop`		Section 6

Stock words mean different things. Do not blur them.

- `available at Stick` : in the store now.
- `available through Stick` : Stick orders it in. Message to order.
- `available for fitting at Stick` : try it in a fitting. Not necessarily for sale off the shelf.
- `available for pre-order` : not yet in. State what happens next.

Each use needs a stock check recorded in the Proof bank. If stock is `UNKNOWN`, the post says "DM us for current availability", which the feed already does.

4. Strategy core

All `CONFIRMED`, from Brand Bible v3 and the Strategy 2026 to 2029. Condensed for the desk.

- **Purpose.** To open the door to better golf for people who want to improve, while rejecting the idea that serious golf must come wrapped in stuffy culture, legacy gatekeeping and expensive nonsense.
- **Core belief.** Everything has to earn its place.
- **Public promise.** Better begins here.
- **Fitting rule.** Fit first. Buy second. (Matches the equipment to the player, not the player to the equipment.)
- **Behaviour rule.** Respect the player. Never use expertise to make the golfer feel stupid.
- **Positioning.** The golf shop with a standard. Modern golfers come to get better, and everything has to earn its place.
- **Archetype.** The Smart Rebel: Rebel plus Sage. "A brand with edge and brains. Not a punk brand. Not an engineering robot."
- **Ambition.** Be the golf shop South African golfers trust to tell them what is actually worth it.
- **Audience, primary.** The "Any Golfer": defined by mindset, not age or handicap. Wants to improve, curious about equipment, values expertise over prestige, open to modern brands, not interested in snobbery.
- **Audience, secondary.** The culturally curious golfer: drawn to modern style and a less intimidating way in, often through Psycho Bunny or indoor golf.

- **They already know:** improvement is possible, equipment matters, fitters and coaches exist. Do not explain what a driver or a fitting is.
- **They worry about:** wasting money, being "fitted wrong" or not knowing enough, being sold something for margin, price shock, too much data.
- **Never make them feel:** patronised, sold to, confused, cheap, generic, intimidated.
- **Enemy.** The old golf culture that equates seriousness with stuffiness, formality and overpriced convention.
- **Pillars (starting shares, not quotas).** Product and brands 40%. Fitting and proof 25%. Workshop and service 20%. Culture, style and people 15%.
- **Stays out of.** Mockery of handicap, age, gender or income. Fake luxury. Country-club heritage. Talking as though only Paarl golfers can buy or be fitted ("proudly Paarl", not "only Paarl").

5. Voice

5.1 Character

- **Voice in five words:** sharp, confident, direct, smart, rebellious. `CONFIRMED` (workbook D, bible 16).
- **How that sounds in the feed:** calm, plain and dry. The rebellion is in what Stick refuses to say, not in volume.
- **If Stick were a person:** the fitter who has seen every excuse, tells you the truth without making you feel small, and does not need to raise their voice.
- **Point of view:** better golf does not require buying into old golf culture, or buying the most expensive thing.
- **We are, but not:**
  - confident, but not cocky: we state, we do not boast.
  - dry, but not sarcastic: the joke is shared, never aimed.
  - technical, but not a lab: a number always comes with its conclusion.
  - local, but not parochial: proudly Paarl, open to the whole Western Cape.
  - edgy, but not hostile: "confidence, not resentment" (bible 16).

5.2 Voice dials

Dial	Setting	The rule that follows
Formality	2 of 5	Contractions are fine. No slang that dates quickly. No "Dear golfer" language either
Humour	2 of 5	One dry beat per caption at most. Understatement over punchline. Skip it when the subject is a price or a booking
Boldness	4 of 5	State the view. "Guessing is expensive golf." No hedging
Technicality	3 of 5	Numbers only with a conclusion beside them. Lead with the golfer's outcome, never with TrackMan
Warmth	3 of 5	"Respect the player" is the warmth. Invite, never lecture
Energy	2 of 5	Calm. No exclamation marks, no caps for volume
Local flavour	2 of 5	Name the place (Paarl, Winelands, Stellenbosch). No braai-ad voice

5.3 Tone shifts by situation

Situation	Tone	Length	Humour?	Opening line, in the real feed's register
Product arrival	Plain and specific	15 to 30 words	A dry line if the product earns it	`Titleist T250 iron set available at Stick.`
Why it's here	Editorial, opinionated, honest about trade-offs	30 to 45 words	Light	`Why it's here: Sausage Putters.`
Fit first and proof	Patient, clear, evidence-led	30 to 50 words	None	`Bring your current clubs.`
Coaching tip	Direct, one useful thing	20 to 40 words	Rare	`A lesson should leave you knowing what to do next.`
Offer	Understated, access not clearance	15 to 25 words	None	State the offer, who, until when, how to claim
Event or opening	Warm and specific	20 to 40 words	Light	Date, time, place first
Style and apparel	Playful, a little arch	15 to 30 words	Yes, this is where it lives	`The Bunny has landed.`
Bad news (delay, stock out)	Plain, quick, no spin	10 to 25 words	None	Say what happened and what happens next
Reply to a happy comment	Short and human	5 to 20 words	Match theirs	Thank them by name only if they are public
Reply to a complaint	Calm, specific, private	15 to 40 words	None	`Sorry about that. Can you DM us the details?`
Reply to a question we cannot answer	Honest	10 to 25 words	None	`Good question. Let us check and come back to you today.`

5.4 Humour, slang and sensitive ground

- **Humour that works (all from the feed):** "Try not to leave with something. No promises." · "No one hovering like a security guard at a jewellery counter." · "Style with a pulse." · "Cute logo. Dangerous charm." Understatement, specific images, the golfer's own habits.
- **Never:** mock handicap, age, gender, income or ability. No sarcasm at a customer. No "tag someone who...". No humour on price, injury, complaints or bad news.
- **Slang allowed:** mate (used 5 times), edge, drop, setup. **Avoid:** `lit`, `fire`, `bro`, `fam`, `hit bombs`.
- **Profanity:** none. The 12 September caption says "bloody good space". Workbook D says none. Rewrite it.
- **Local words:** place names. "Mate" sparingly. No forced Afrikaans or township slang.
- **Never joke about:** a customer's swing or body, money trouble, injuries, anyone who has not agreed to be in the joke.

6. Lexicon

Signature lines

Line	Where it goes
`Better begins here.`	Last line of nearly every caption (see section 16). Never in the middle. Never beside `Better golf starts here.`

Line	Where it goes
`Everything has to earn its place.`	Editorial and brand pieces, and the belief line behind Why it's here. Not a sign-off
`Fit first. Buy second.`	Fitting and performance equipment posts
`Why it's here.`	Title of the product editorial series
`Respect the player.`	Behaviour rule. Rarely printed. Always obeyed
`Built at Stick.`	Workshop series
`Ask Stick.`	Question and answer series
`Style that belongs.`	Apparel series
`Product drop.`	New and limited stock

Approved calls to action (L5.6)

One per caption. Pick from this list only. The "how" is part of the CTA.

CTA	Use for	Status
`DM us to book a fitting.`	Fitting and equipment	**DRAFT** (DM is the real route: 82 captions)
`Book a fitting at Stick.`	Fitting with a booking link in bio or on the creative	**DRAFT** (17 captions use "Book a ... at Stick")
`Book a lesson at Stick.` / `Book coaching at Stick.`	Coaching	**DRAFT**
`Book a club assessment on us. DM to book.`	The assessment offer, only while it is live	**DRAFT**, offer status **UNKNOWN**
`DM us for current availability.`	Stock unknown or moving	**DRAFT**
`DM us for price and details.`	Product posts without a printed price	**DRAFT** (76 captions use "DM us for...")
`Message us to order.`	Order-in items such as Mileseey	**DRAFT**
`Come roll one at Stick.` / `Come try one at Stick.`	Putters, grips, bags	**DRAFT**
`Visit us at Winelands Square.`	Events, openings, local posts	**DRAFT**
`DM us to secure yours.`	Limited stock and drops, only where the stock is real	**DRAFT** (the 10 June Srixon caption)

In the machine rules (kept in the repository) a `*` in a call to action means "any words", so `DM us to *.` covers `DM us to book a fitting.` and `DM us to secure yours.`

The workbook's approved list (Book a fitting, Enquire, Find your fit, View product, Try it on, Visit us, Message to order, Ask us, Shop the drop, Get your spec done) remains valid wording. Choose one phrasing per action and stay with it.

Banned for Stick (adds to L7)

Phrase	Why
`Come experience the effect in-store`	Vague and repeated. Appears in 13 captions and says nothing
`Come experience ...`	16 captions, 24 April to 10 August. Experience what?

Phrase	Why
`Better golf starts here.` beside the tagline	It competes with `Better begins here.`
`guaranteed to improve your game`	Unverifiable (L4.1). One caption, 28 April
`Your clubs deserve the best.` and similar	Generic, passes the swap test for any shop
`Hit bombs`	Slang that cheapens the product
`Spoiler alert` , `Ever wonder why ...?`	AI-sounding openers (see section 15)
`First 30 people to tag ...` , `like and tag`	Engagement bait. 10 captions, 19 to 25 March
Percentage-off lines	"STICK does not do discount theatre" (workbook K)
Anything mocking the golfer	Respect the player
`bloody` , any profanity	Workbook D
`Swing Shack` , `Bag Drop`	Without approver sign-off in the current message
`Done properly.` as filler	Allowed once in the launch lock-up. Not as a habit
Mentioning TrackMan as the point of the post	The tool is not the personality

Watch words (max one per caption)

`premium` (6 captions, usually empty), `proper` or `properly` (8), `clean` (15), `serious` , `sharp` . They are fine once, and a tell when they appear four times in a feed.

Say this, not that

Say this	Not that	Why
`Come try one at Stick.`	`Come experience the effect in-store.`	Specific action
`Fitting is not a reward for being good at golf.`	`Everyone deserves a fitting!`	Plain and true, no exclamation
`Available at Stick.`	`Now at your favourite golf spot!`	Our idiom, no filler
`Guessing is expensive golf.`	`Stop wasting money on the wrong clubs!`	Dry, not scolding
`Same head. Different shaft position. Completely different feel.`	`Experience next-level putting innovation.`	Says what actually changes
`Book a club assessment.`	`Unlock your potential with a free assessment.`	No empty promise
`We measure what they do, change one variable at a time.`	`Our state-of-the-art fitting process.`	Process, not adjectives
`Psycho Bunny brings a bit more attitude.`	`Elevate your wardrobe.`	Specific, our register

7. Messaging and the Proof bank

Master message

STICK is where modern golfers come to get better, and everything has to earn its place.

Supporting messages, ranked

1. Golf without the old gatekeeping.
2. Better decisions, better golf.
3. Quality is not one-size-fits-all.
4. Modern golf is already here.
5. Style and performance belong together.

Seasonal emphasis

Pre-season (January to March): start the season fitted. Winter workshop (May to July): loft and lie checks, regrips, bag refresh. Gift season (November to December): Psycho Bunny, bags, putters. Product drops: as stock arrives, not by calendar. `CONFIRMED` (workbook E).

Proof bank

Copy may state a fact only if it is here, not expired, and the status allows it. `CONFIRMED` rows can be used. `DRAFT` rows can be used only after someone checks them on the day. `UNKNOWN` means silence.

Fact (as it may be written)	Value	Source	Verified	Expires	Status
Location	Paarl, Western Cape	Strategy section 4	2026-09-23	never	**CONFIRMED**
Booking page	stickgolf.co.za/bookings/	`knowledge.json`	2026-09-23	re-check monthly	**CONFIRMED**
Services	Brand-agnostic TrackMan fittings. Full shaft matrix. Precision workshop.	stickgolf.co.za, `knowledge.json`	2026-09-23	6 months	**CONFIRMED**
TrackMan is used in fittings	Yes	Workbook E	2026-09-23	never	**CONFIRMED**
Fitting philosophy	Stick matches equipment to the player, not the player to the equipment	Bible section 4	2026-09-23	never	**CONFIRMED**
Stick is a sister brand to Swing Shack, not a sub-brand	Yes	`knowledge.json`	2026-09-23	never	**CONFIRMED**
Brands stocked	Takomo, Vice, Psycho Bunny, L.A.B. Golf, Avoda, Vessel, RipIt	stickgolf.co.za	2026-09-23	3 months	**CONFIRMED** (spelling of RipIt: unknown)
Further brands the feed says Stick sells	Titleist (GTS drivers, T250 irons, Vokey wedges), Scotty Cameron putters, Srixon, Jordan bags, Callaway Quantum mini drivers (for fitting), Sub 70 (for fitting), Mileseey (order-in), Sausage Putters, Fujimoto and Miura (named in 9 April videos)	Feed, April to October	not verified	per post	**DRAFT**
Address	Winelands Square, corner R101 and Sandwyk Street, Paarl, 7646	Posts of 2 and 7 April	not verified	never	**DRAFT**
Opened	1 May 2026	Feed	not verified	never	**DRAFT**
Recruitment email	work@stickgolf.co.za	Post of 19 July	not verified	while vacancy open	**DRAFT**, hiring posts only

Fact (as it may be written)	Value	Source	Verified	Expires	Status
Drive times	24 min from Stellenbosch, 25 from Franschhoek, 36 from Somerset West, 46 from Green Point	Posts of 15 to 19 May	not verified	per post	DRAFT. Say "about", name the route, or do not use
A priced item	Srixon Limited Edition US Open stand bag with three matching headcovers, R7,999, two available	Posts of 10 and 11 June	stale	expired	DRAFT. Historical only
Opening hours					UNKNOWN
Phone and WhatsApp					UNKNOWN
Current offers					UNKNOWN. The free 30-minute assessment ran in March and April. "Book a club assessment on us" ran in June and July. Whether either is live today is not recorded
Number of fittings, members, customers, improvements					UNKNOWN. Never state one
Staff roles	Jared, club fitter. Dave, fitter. Blake Sutherland, coach	Feed	not verified	per post	DRAFT

Internal figures that must never reach public copy: weekly reach, cost per click, cost per lead, Fit Facts results, search impressions, GBP interactions (strategy section 1). They are evidence for decisions, not claims for captions.

Banned fabrications (`knowledge.json` , Christelle directive 2026-09-23): no fake TrackMan numbers, no fake fitting outcomes, no "12-shot improvement" or "two-week guarantee" claims, no fake member counts, no fake distance claims. A number that is not in this table is not allowed.

Offer register

Offer	What	Who	Ends	How to claim	Approved wording	Status
Club assessment	A look at length, lie, shafts, grips, gapping and set make-up, "on us"	Anyone who brings their current set	UNKNOWN	DM to book	`Book a club assessment on us.`	UNKNOWN, confirm live

Understated, per workbook K: frame limited-time pricing as "early-season pricing" or "introductory access", never "% off". Scarcity is allowed only when true: "One available", "Last one", "SOLD once gone". Never invent it.

8. Caption lanes

Lane definitions come from the strategy's six designed layers plus the lanes the feed actually runs. Lengths use the feed's measured median by lane as a starting band. The feed was classified with a keyword pass, so treat lane counts as approximate.

```
LANE: Product arrival
Purpose:            Tell golfers a thing is here and why it is worth their time
Audience:           Any Golfer; equipment nerds
Frequency:          Permanent. About 108 of 258 feed captions
Anatomy:            Hook (the product) / one-line character / CTA / sign-off
Length:             15 to 30 words, 3 to 5 lines (feed median 20.5)
Hook patterns:      "[Brand] [product] available at Stick." / "[Short line about the thing]." / "[Product] is in
the fitting bay."
CTA:                DM us for price and details. / Message us to order.
Voice dials:        Humour 2, technicality 2
On-image text:      stick-product-post (no template pack yet)
Approved example:   Titleist T250, 2 July (below)
Rejected example:   "Great clubs deserve a great bag." (generic, passes the swap test)
Notes:              Stock check required (section 3). Never use the same product line on more than three
consecutive days without a new angle

LANE: Why it's here
Purpose:            Explain why Stick made space for a product or brand
Anatomy:            Title / the reason / one honest trade-off or use case / CTA / sign-off
Length:             30 to 45 words (feed median 39.5)
Hook patterns:      "Why it's here: [product]." / "[Short claim about what it does]."
CTA:                Come try one at Stick. / Book a fitting at Stick.
Approved example:   Sausage Putters, 17 September
Notes:              Not "here's what we stock". "Here's why we bothered stocking it." (strategy section 6)

LANE: Fit first
Purpose:            Show that equipment is chosen through fitting, not guesswork
Anatomy:            Baseline or problem / what we measured / what changed / CTA / sign-off
Length:             30 to 50 words
Hook patterns:      "Fit first. Buy second." / "Bring your current clubs." / "[A true thing about a miss]."
CTA:                Book a fitting at Stick.
Approved example:   16 and 18 September
Notes:              Data only from a real, consented fitting (L4.6). No invented numbers

LANE: Coaching and tip of the week
Purpose:            One useful idea
Anatomy:            Hook / the idea / CTA / sign-off
Length:             20 to 40 words
CTA:                Book a lesson at Stick.
Approved example:   3 September, 14 September
Notes:              One useful change beats ten clever observations. Never mock the swing

LANE: Built at Stick (workshop)
Purpose:            Turn craft into content: builds, loft and lie, regrips, shaft work
Anatomy:            Job title / spec in plain words / outcome / CTA
Length:             20 to 40 words
CTA:                Book a service at Stick. / DM us for your spec.
Notes:              Weekly minimum in the strategy. The feed has almost none. The biggest gap

LANE: Ask Stick
Purpose:            One golfer question, one clear answer
Anatomy:            Question / answer / next step
Length:             25 to 45 words
CTA:                DM us. / Ask us at Stick.
Notes:              2 to 3 per month minimum (workbook J). The feed has none

LANE: Style that belongs (apparel)
Purpose:            Show that style and performance belong together
Anatomy:            Hook / one detail / availability line / sign-off
Length:             15 to 30 words
Hook patterns:      "The Bunny has landed." / "Style that belongs."
CTA:                Visit us. / Message us for current stock.
Approved example:   "The Bunny has landed. A little too good at looking good." (7 June)
Notes:              Six-week campaign cycle. Where humour is most welcome

LANE: Product drop and limited stock
Purpose:            Timely reveal
```

```
Anatomy:            Reveal / what it is / availability / route / sign-off
Length:             15 to 30 words
CTA:                DM us to secure yours.
Approved example:   Srixon US Open bag, 10 June (price and scarcity stated plainly)
Notes:              Only true scarcity. Price in the caption, not the headline, unless value is the story
(workbook K)

LANE: Place and people
Purpose:            Make Stick feel like somewhere worth the drive
Anatomy:            Hook / the place or person / reason to visit / sign-off
Length:             15 to 35 words (feed median 23.5)
CTA:                Visit us at Winelands Square.
Approved example:   21 May "There's a new golf spot in Paarl."
Notes:              Proudly Paarl, not only Paarl. Drive-time lines need verified times

LANE: Events, openings and hiring
Purpose:            Practical information
Anatomy:            What / when / where / how to join
Length:             20 to 50 words
CTA:                Comment or DM for the invite.
Notes:              Date format and address exact. No markdown asterisks (the 7 April caption printed them)
```

Retired lanes: the pre-launch "free swing assessment and % off" run (March to April, 55 captions), and the dictionary-definition opener ("stick /stɪk/ noun", 19 captions). Both belonged to the build-up to opening. Reuse only with the owners' approval.

9. Channel rules

Content from workbook L, updated with what the feed does. `DRAFT`.

Channel	Role	Formats	Length	Hashtags	Tags	CTA	Reply voice	Avoid
Instagram feed	Authority and product showcase, longest shelf life	Carousel (educational, product), static product hero, Reel cross-posts	Per lane	0 to 5, last	Partners welcome. Photographer credit line	Per lane	Short, human, same voice	Throwaway posts, poor crops, promotion with no reason
Instagram Stories	Fast texture: drops, polls, in-shop moments	Stories-native, polls, reposted mentions, SOLD alerts	1 to 2 lines per frame	None	Stickers fine	Message, Tap	Same	Clutter, text-heavy slides
Reels	Engagement and proof: fitting before and after, workshop, comparisons	9:16, 15 to 60 seconds, intro and outro frame	Caption per lane	0 to 5		Book, Enquire, Visit	Same	Phone footage with no Stick frame, talking head with no b-roll, no on-screen text
Facebook	Longer form and local: events, testimonials	Feed, Reels, Events	Per lane, may run longer	None		Learn more, Book, Visit	Same	Duplicating Instagram with no context

Channel	Role	Formats	Length	Hashtags	Tags	CTA	Reply voice	Avoid
Paid ads	Distribution	Feed, Reel, Story, carousel	Per brief	None		Enquire, Book, Shop	n/a	Cheap traffic with no purchase measure. Note: Christelle's rule is that ad creative is real human video (see project memory)
Website	Conversion and search	Product pages, Why it's here editorial, fitting pages	Per page	n/a		Book a fitting, Enquire, Shop	n/a	Generic listings with no Stick reason, outdated stock
Google Business Profile	Local search and credibility	Posts, Q&A, catalogue	1 to 3 sentences	None		Call, Visit, Message	Same, within a day	Inconsistent posting, unanswered Q&A
WhatsApp, email	UNKNOWN							Not set up in the repo. Fill in

10. Customer conversation

- **Who replies:** UNKNOWN. Name one person and one backup.
- **Speed:** within a working day for DMs and comments. `DRAFT`.
- **Comments:** thank briefly, answer the question, move any price or booking detail to DM. Never argue in public.
- **DMs:** first reply names what they asked about and what happens next. "Hi [name], thanks for asking about the [product]. It is [in stock / can be ordered]. Want to book a fitting or come in?"
- **Complaints:** acknowledge, apologise for the experience without admitting fault in public, take it private, fix it, never delete a fair complaint.
- **Reviews:** thank, be specific, never defensive. Same voice as the feed.
- **Escalate to an owner:** pricing disputes, injury, legal threats, press, anything about a named person, any complaint about a fitting outcome.
- **Sensitive moments:** pause scheduled posts, hold a short plain statement, owner approves.
- Reply examples are in section 5.3.

11. Visual identity

Lives in: workbook F, `palette/brand.json`, `typography/fonts.json`, `bible-visual.json`.

Colours and fonts are unconfirmed and the sources disagree. Do not recolour from this table. See `CampaignOS/decisions/everything-runs-through-brand-bibles-2026-10-12.md` in the wiki.

Element	Workbook F says	Renderer uses	Source of truth
Primary	Deep teal `#004D5A`, charcoal `#1A1A1A`	Navy `#073C52` (measured from the feed)	UNKNOWN. Stick's own partner artwork measures `#003048` to `#003C54`, which matches the renderer, not the workbook

Element	Workbook F says	Renderer uses	Source of truth
Accent	Amber `#F0A030`	Teal `#00B3BA`, mint `#24FFAF`	**UNKNOWN**
Backgrounds	`#0D0D0D`, `#121212`		
Fonts	Inter, JetBrains Mono (data)	Montserrat	**UNKNOWN**. Workbook S asks to confirm
Logo	Clear space = height of the S. Never recolour, gradient, shadow or stretch. Min 24 px digital, 15 mm print	`stick/logo.png`	Confirm files with the designer
Layout	Text in top or bottom 30%. Headline never overlaps the product. Logo top-left or bottom-centre, fixed per format	Per template	**CONFIRMED** (workbook F)
Devices	Why it's here frame, build sheet overlay, before and after split, data callout, `Better begins here` end lock-up		**CONFIRMED**

12. Photography and imagery

`CONFIRMED` from workbook G, plus Christelle's rules.

- **Look:** performance minimalism with attitude. High contrast, deep blacks, product as hero, slightly desaturated, never oversaturated.
- **Location:** the Stick studio is the location. Dark matte surfaces, wood, stone, the fitting bay, the workshop bench, the shaft wall. Never a golf course as the primary setting.
- **People:** real golfers, fitters and coaches. Not models. Natural expressions. Hands at work in the workshop. A golfer reacting to a TrackMan result.
- **Real over generated:** never render a fake bay, a fake product or a fake venue. Real location and product photos exist for Stick. (Christelle, 2026-10-12.)
- **Grade:** blacks at `#121212` or deeper. Skin tones natural. Product colours exact. Amber and teal in overlays only, never on the product.
- **Rejected looks:** course backgrounds, faux luxury (marble, gold, crystal), pro-shop clutter, leather, mahogany, tartan, brass, over-posed stock models, product with the brand name larger than the product or the reason.
- **Image generation:** allowed only for genuinely new looks that photography cannot supply, never for product, venue or people. The workbook's master negative prompt (section R) applies.

13. Product and asset fidelity

`CONFIRMED` (workbook H). Geometry, colour, finish, markings, logo placement, proportions, handedness and model names are never altered in any render or edit. Product colours are exact. A TrackMan screen is shown only if it is the real interface with real data. Real photos live in `images/Products/`, `images/Location/` and `images/Services/` (pulled from Drive, not in git).

14. Templates and deterministic layers

Measured templates for Stick exist as `shop-corner`, `service-hero`, `service-frame`, `service-start`, `service-end`, `service-square`, `coach-profile`, `coaching-poster`, `location-drive` and `brand-statement` (`templates/`). Specs are in `visual-spec/archetypes.json`.

Gap	Effect
`stick-product-post` has no template pack	No product layout exists that keeps text off the product
`@ stick` partner panel not measured	It recurs across the feed and cannot be rendered
`service-hero-v1` puts navy text on a dark photo	Unreadable on dark bay photos
`shop-corner` plate can cover the product on close-ups	Breaks "never cover the product"

- Logo, price, date, legal copy and CTA are added by the deterministic layer, never typed by an image model.
- Write copy **under** the declared limit, not at it (7 of 14 renderable packs cannot compose copy filled to their declared budget).
- Run `/render-post --list` for current templates and limits before writing on-image copy.

15. Reference library

Golden examples

Real captions from the feed. "Rules modelled" are from the template.

#	Date and lane	Caption	Why it works	Rules
1	4 Sep, Fit first	`You can be fit for a golf ball without being a low-handicap golfer. / Fitting is not a reward for being good at golf. / It is simply a better way to choose equipment. / Book a fitting at Stick. / Better begins here.`	Respect the player in practice. Removes a worry (not good enough), one clear CTA, calm	L5.1, L5.6, L6.3, L6.6
2	3 Sep, Coaching	`A lesson should leave you knowing what to do next. / Not carrying twelve swing thoughts to the first tee. / Book coaching at Stick. / Better begins here.`	A specific, relatable image. One idea. Passes the swap test	L6.1, L6.2, L5.2
3	17 Sep, Why it's here	`Why it's here: Sausage Putters. / Different is only interesting if it still does the job. ... Come roll one and make your own call.`	The property named, the honest trade-off ("different is only interesting if..."), invites the reader to judge	L6.1, L4.2
4	18 Sep, Fit first	`Bring your current clubs. / If the new option cannot beat what you already own in a meaningful way, that tells us something useful. / Book a fitting at Stick.`	Shows honesty over margin, the brand's core promise	L4.2, L6.5
5	2 Jul, Product arrival	`Titleist T250 iron set available at Stick. / S300 shafts. 4-PW. / Fast face. Cleaner shape. More help than it lets on. / DM us for price and details. / Better begins here.`	Plain idiom, concrete spec, one dry line, one CTA. Check the spec against the product on the day	L5.1, L5.6, L4.1
6	10 Jun, Product drop	`The Limited Edition Srixon US Open Stand Bag is here. / Includes three matching headcovers. / R7,999. / Only two available. / DM us to secure yours.`	Price, scarcity and route stated plainly. Understated, no hype	L4.3, L3.2
7	21 May, Place	`There's a new golf spot in Paarl. / You'll find us at Winelands Square. / Look for the Stick sign. / Walk in. / Try not to leave with something. / No promises.`	The voice at its best: dry, specific, inviting. Caption adds what the image cannot	L6.1, L5.5
8	7 Jun, Style	`The Bunny has landed. / A little too good at looking good. / Psycho Bunny available at Stick. / Better begins here.`	A recurring hook that earns its repetition. The lane where play belongs	L5.1, L6.8

Rejected examples

#	Date	Caption (shortened)	Rules broken	The fix
1	29 Sep	`Ever wonder why your clubs feel more like a punishment than a partner? Spoiler alert: it might be because they're not fitted to you. Get the gear that actually fits your game.`	L7 (`Ever wonder` , `Spoiler alert`), L6.2 (fails the swap test), L5.1 (hook is a question), one long paragraph, no CTA from the list, "Better begins here." tacked on	`Clubs that are not fitted to you cost you shots. A fitting finds out which ones. Book a fitting at Stick. / Better begins here.`
2	28 Sep	`"Swing hard and hope for the best" may be a popular mantra, but it's about as effective as playing golf in flip-flops. TrackMan helps you discover your swing's tempo ... Why leave your performance to chance when you can get data-driven insights? Your game deserves better.`	Wall of text (L5.4), TrackMan as the headline (workbook N), `data-driven insights` , `Your game deserves better.` , rhetorical question (L7), no CTA, no sign-off, off-voice	`Swinging harder is not a plan. Tempo is. We measure yours and build the drill around it. Book a lesson at Stick. / Better begins here.`
3	6 Aug	`Come experience the latest Sub 70 range at Stick. / ✓ Professional fitting / ✓ Premium shafts / ✓ Built to your specs / Book your fitting today. / Better begins today.`	Sign-off misspelt (L5.7), emoji bullets (L5.9), `premium` , "Come experience"	`Sub 70 is now available for fitting at Stick. Find the right head, shaft and setup with a fitter. Book a fitting at Stick. / Better begins here.`
4	19 Mar	`20% off full bag fittings / First 30 people to tag someone who blames the wind.`	Engagement bait (L7), percentage off (workbook K), two ideas	State the offer plainly with what, who, until when, how, or do not run it
5	28 Apr	`Inviting, forward-thinking, sharp, and guaranteed to improve your game.`	Three adjectives (L7), unverifiable guarantee (L4.1), Oxford comma against the setting (L2.7)	Say what Stick does: `A fitting finds the clubs that suit your swing.`
6	22 May	`Meet Jared. ... then helps you find what actually belongs in your bag.` (contains an em dash)	L2.2. "Your new excuse remover" is a good line that is worth keeping	Replace the dash with a full stop
7	7 Apr	`**29 April 2026 15:00-18:00**` … `Corner R101 and, Sandwyk St, Paarl, 7646`	Markdown asterisks show as literal text, double space, wrong date and time format, stray comma	`29 April 2026, 15:00 to 18:00. / Winelands Square, corner R101 and Sandwyk Street, Paarl, 7646.`
8	24 Apr to 8 May	13 captions containing `Come experience the effect in-store.`	Filler repeated until the feed reads like a template (L6.2)	`Come try one at Stick.` or nothing
9	12 Jun	`Rush Naidoo's new iron build ...` posted twice, once as `Rush Naidoo new iron build`	L1.3 (duplicate with a different spelling), L4.6 (consent for a named customer and their data is not on file)	One post, correct spelling, consent recorded
10	17 Jul	`Premium golf gear should feel premium.`	Circular (L6.10), `premium` twice	Say what is good about the bag

16. Feed truth and reconciliation

Counted 2026-10-13 from `feedback/instagram-audit.json` : 261 posts, 258 with a caption, 10 March to 5 October 2026. By type: 130 videos, 104 images, 27 carousels.

Question	The bible says	The feed shows	Decision
Tagline	"Better Begins Here" (title case)	In 173 captions. Closes 136 (116 as exactly `Better begins here.`)	Sentence case with a full stop at the end of the caption (decision 2)

Question	The bible says	The feed shows	Decision
Sign-off errors		`Better Begins Here.` 3, no full stop 2, `Better begins today.` 1, emoji after it 14, quoted 1	Fix. One form
Caption length	Short to medium, one idea per sentence	Median 20 words. 11 in April, 35 in September	The September length is the target for editorial lanes. Product arrivals can stay near 20
CTA	Book a fitting, Enquire, Find your fit ...	`DM us for ...` in 76, `DM us` in 82, `Book ... at Stick` in 17, `link in bio` in 5. 102 captions have no recognisable CTA	One CTA from the approved list (section 6)
Lane mix	40% product, 25% fitting and proof, 20% workshop, 15% culture	About 42% product arrival, 7% fitting and coaching, workshop close to zero, Ask Stick zero	Product is on target. Workshop and Ask Stick are the gaps
Hashtags		5 captions (June, September)	Section 2
Emoji	"Rare"	26 captions, 18 in April	None
Exclamation marks	Only for genuine excitement	4 captions, all "Know your swing!" pre-launch	Keep rare
Em dashes	Banned	2 (22 and 28 May)	Remove from future copy. Old posts may be left
Questions		6 captions (24 and 29 July, 2 and 3 August, 28 and 29 September). The two off-voice September captions are among them	A question is allowed only when the caption answers it
Humour	"Wry, never clownish"	Dry in product and place posts. The sarcasm in the old README is not in the feed	The old README and `voice/` files are wrong on this point
Spelling of names		`stick`, `Stick` and `STICK` all used. `Psychobunny`. Ripit three ways	Section 3
Local reference	Light	Paarl in 50 captions, Winelands in 6	On target
Engagement bait		`tag` or `like and tag` in 10 captions, all 19 to 25 March	Retired
Contradictions inside the old `voice/` files		`tone-rules.md` says "not a meme sub-brand". `punctuation-rules.md` says "the meme side of Swing Shack". README says "sub-brand of Swing Shack". `do-say-dont-say.md` bans "world-class" and the headline bank uses sarcasm the feed never does	This bible supersedes `voice/` and `copy/headlines.md` once confirmed
Performance		Likes average about 5 per post. The two highest are the opening-day video (118) and the launch-party video (44)	The feed shows what Stick does, not what performs. Do not read engagement as proof of a voice

Eras the feed passes through. March: pre-launch ("Stick is coming to Paarl", free assessment, percentage offers). Early April: launch and brand introductions. Mid April to August: product arrivals, mostly two to four lines. September: the strategy-era voice (Why it's here, Fit first, Style that belongs, Tip of the week), with fuller sentences. The September posts are the model. The two AI-sounding captions on 28 and 29 September sit outside it.

17. Governance

- **Change process:** propose in the wiki or a pull request, the approver says yes in the current message, the change is logged below.

- **Who may publish without review:** product arrivals and place posts, if they pass the Gate with no hard fails and 12 or more out of 16, and every fact is `CONFIRMED` in the Proof bank. Offers, events, anything with a price, a named person or a claim need approver review.
- **Where this is the source of truth:** the copy rules, names, facts and lanes. Where it disagrees with `voice/`, `copy/` or `README.md`, this wins once confirmed. Those files should then be regenerated or deleted.
- **Upstream sources:** Brand Bible v3 and the Strategy are the owners' documents. If they change, this file changes.

Change log

Date	Section	Change	Approved by
2026-10-13	all	First draft from the template	pending

Open questions

Question	Owner	By
Decisions 1 to 14 at the top	Christelle, then approvers	
Hours, phone, WhatsApp	Christelle	
Is the free club assessment live today?	Christelle	
Who replies to DMs and comments?	Christelle	
Confirm colours, fonts and logo files (section 11)	Christelle, designer	
Confirm stock list and supplier spellings (section 3)	Christelle, Dave	
Consent on file for named customers and staff	Christelle	

CHAPTER D

Swing Shack

Brand bible, draft 1

Written 2026-10-13 from: the Swing Shack Full Brand Bible Draft v1 and Brand Essentials (`bible-source.txt` , `essentials-source.txt`), the workbook's Swing Shack sections (`workbook-source.txt`), `knowledge.json` (verified 2026-09-23), the old `voice/` and `copy/` files, and **the whole feed in** `feedback/instagram-audit.json` : 789 posts, 764 of them with a caption, 16 December 2022 to 13 October 2026, account `swingshack` . That audit did not exist before today. It was pulled on 2026-10-13 with `/audit-social swing-shack --no-images` . **Scope of the numbers:** counts and examples come from the 200 most recent posts (10 October 2025 to 13 October 2026) unless a line says "whole feed". All 564 older captions were read and measured as well; where they change a finding, the text says so. Every count was run on 2026-10-13. To reproduce a recent-window count, run `caption_lint.py swing-shack --audit --since 2025-10-10` .

Status: `DRAFT` . Nothing here is `CONFIRMED` unless a source is named beside it. The approver has not signed it.

Read this first: three findings that change what is safe to publish

1. **Performance numbers have been published that are not in any verified source.** Examples, all from the feed: "87% of golfers who get fit lower their handicap. That's fact, not opinion." (20 Nov 2025). "Fitted clubs can take up to 5 shots off your game guaranteed!" (23 Oct 2025). "20% more fairway accuracy after proper fitting" (3 Nov). "up to 25 meters" (20 Oct), "up to 19 metres" (10 Nov), "as many as 6 shots per round" (14 Nov). "From 165m slice to 265m straight", "Club speed: 142km/h to 158km/h", "Accuracy: +32%" under the words "Real South African results" (30 Mar 2026). "Pros average 112 mph" and "264 meters" (1 Apr). The habit is older: "Golfers gain an average of 10 meters in total distance with an optimally fit driver" (9 Feb 2024) and "87% of golfers reduce their handicap by at least 10% with properly fit clubs" (16 Feb 2024, then again on 20 Nov 2025). Swing Shack's own `knowledge.json` says: no "90% / 30-metre" stats, no fake TrackMan numbers, no fake fitting outcomes, "any number not in this file is not allowed in copy". None of these numbers is in that file. Whether any of them came from real data is not recorded anywhere in the repo. They should be treated as unsubstantiated until someone shows the source, and "guaranteed" should come out of any future copy regardless. Advertising regulators expect performance claims to be substantiated, so this is more than a style point. The owners should look at these posts.
2. **The workbook's six recurring properties do not appear in a single caption, but the feed has series of its own that the workbook does not know about.** "What Does Your Swing Say?", "The 10-Ball Truth", "Shack Sessions", "The Truth About...", "Golf Is More Fun When...", "Before / After / Why": zero of 764 captions name any of them, and the platform line "Golf is more fun when it makes sense" appears in none. They may be on screen inside the videos, which the audit cannot see. What the captions do show: **Build of the Week** (24 captions, 28 Sep 2024 to 22 Jul 2026), **"Did you know"** (13, 23 Aug 2025 to 21 Jan 2026), **Tip of the Week** (9, 2024), **"Myth vs Reality"** (6, Oct to Dec 2024), a weekly **"Big week at Swing Shack"** schedule post (10, Mar to Aug 2025), **course-of-the-week** "now on TrackMan" posts (11, 2025), **ambassador profiles** (12, Mar to Jun 2025), and **Shack Labs** (4, Sep to Oct 2025). Which set the owners want is decision 15.
3. **For about eleven weeks Swing Shack and Stick posted the same product copy with the name swapped.** 24 of Swing Shack's 200 captions share at least one full line with a Stick caption, 26 distinct lines in all, between 26 May and 5 August 2026. Five of the 26 are calls to action ("DM us for price and details."), which are meant to repeat. Setting those aside, 20 captions share a line of actual copy, and the linter counts those. Titleist GTS, Scotty Cameron, Mileseey, Callaway Quantum, Sub 70, the Srixon bag and the ball-fitting campaign all ran as the same sentences on both feeds. Two sister brands with different promises cannot sound the same. The swap test (L6.2) now includes swapping the sister brand, section 17.

Decisions needed before this can be marked CONFIRMED

Each has a recommendation and the evidence.

#	Decision	Recommendation	Evidence
1	**Unsubstantiated claims** (finding 1).	Stop using every figure on the list above. Ask the owners whether any came from real data. Nothing goes back in without a row in the Proof bank.	Section 7
2	**The voice.** Four sources, four answers. Bible v1: precise, calm, confident, warm, "the sharp performance coach who is also a great host". Workbook: warm, knowledgeable, witty, useful, confident. Old `voice/` files: "data-driven coach, no-nonsense", "not a joke brand". Feed: emoji-heavy and promotional.	Use Bible v1's description. Warm, precise, dry. Humour as understatement.	Bible v1 sections 9 and 11. The best captions in the feed already sound like this (section 15)
3	**Emoji.**	At most one per post, from a short list, and not on most posts.	Emoji on 131 of the last 200 captions (66%), median two, 41 with three or more. Whole feed: 400 of 764 (52%). Workbook D: "occasional and intentional... never as a crutch"
4	**Hashtags.**	Zero to three, CamelCase, relevant.	On 87 of the last 200 captions, 32 with five or more. Whole feed: 392 of 764 (51%), 171 with five or more. `#golf #golflife #coach` appears together on 19, including on fitting posts where `#coach` is wrong
5	**Tagline and sign-off.**	Public tagline `Real golf, indoors.` Belief line `Golf is more fun when it makes sense.` Neither forced onto every caption.	Bible v1 and workbook give "Real Golf, Indoors" as the public line. Workbook B gives "Golf is more fun when it makes sense" as the belief and promise, and workbook S says to decide which leads. The feed uses neither: `Real golf` in 1 caption, the belief line in 0
6	**Membership price.**	Confirm which is current.	21 and 28 Dec 2024: "R3,850/year or R350/month" for 2025. 10 Jun 2026: "R2,475 for the rest of 2026". 26 Aug 2026: "For only 399/pm". The last two cannot both be right
7	**Units.**	Metres and km/h.	1 Apr post mixes "83 MPH" and "29 meters". 30 Mar post uses km/h and metres. "meters" 3 times, "metres" once
8	**Currency.**	`R7,999`, as Stick.	Feed has `R7999.00`, `R7,999`, `R820`, `399/pm`
9	**"Club", never "studio".**	Always "indoor golf club".	Bible v1: "South Africa's first and only true indoor golf club... not an arcade". Two captions on 30 Mar say "indoor golf studio", one says "premier"
10	**Same copy as Stick.**	Never post the same line on both brands within 90 days. Product posts carry a reason specific to the brand.	Finding 3
11	**Competitions, codes and Black Friday.**	Allowed when plain and complete: what, who, until when, how. Not "Don't Miss Out".	10 competition captions, `FITTING15` (expired 31 May), Black Friday on 18 and 25 Nov. Workbook K: offers should feel "welcoming, not urgent"

#	Decision	Recommendation	Evidence
12	**Unicode "bold" text and ALL-CAPS headlines.**	Banned.	10 captions use mathematical bold letters, including the membership prices. Screen readers and search cannot read them. 12 captions open on an all-caps line, 30 Mar to 21 May and 5 Oct
13	**Named people.**	Consent on file before naming a member, winner or staff member.	"Congratulations to Barend Fourie, the winner of our L.A.B. Competition" (3 Nov). Coach Cat, Divan, FJ, Dawid, and `@lampsdave` appear. No consent record in the repo
14	**Mentioning Stick.**	Banned in copy unless the approver says yes in the current message.	0 captions mention Stick. Keep it that way
15	**Which recurring series?** The workbook's six, or the ones the feed already runs (Build of the Week, Did you know, Shack Labs, Tip of the Week, Myth vs Reality).	If the workbook's six run as video titles, say so. Otherwise keep the feed's series, which have a real record, and add the workbook's as planned.	Finding 2
16	**Approver.**	Hermanus Kriel.	Workbook A, `knowledge.json`
17	**Partner brand spellings.**	Confirm with suppliers: L.A.B., LA Golf, Ripit, Avoda, Sausage Golf.	The feed spells each more than one way

0. Document control

Field	Value	Status
Brand	Swing Shack	CONFIRMED (workbook A)
Bible version	Template v1, Swing Shack draft 1, 2026-10-13	DRAFT
Owner (writes and maintains)	Christelle (marketing)	DRAFT
Approver (signs changes)	Hermanus Kriel	CONFIRMED as brand owner (workbook A); approval role DRAFT
Next review	2027-01-13, and after any rebrand	DRAFT
Sources	See header	CONFIRMED

Section status: 0 to 3 DRAFT · 4 CONFIRMED (from bible and workbook) · 5 DRAFT · 6 DRAFT · 7 mixed, row by row · 8 DRAFT · 9 DRAFT · 10 DRAFT · 11 CONFIRMED for colours, fonts and logo (the designer's document), layout and devices from workbook F · 12 and 13 CONFIRMED (workbook G, N) · 14 DRAFT · 15 DRAFT · 16 CONFIRMED (counted) · 17 DRAFT.

1. Snapshot

Field	Value	Status
Trading name	Swing Shack	CONFIRMED

Field	Value	Status
Website	swingshack.co.za	CONFIRMED
Booking page	swingshack.co.za/bookings/	CONFIRMED 2026-09-23 (`knowledge.json`); re-check before use
Location	Old Parktonian Sports Club, 1 Garden Road, Bordeaux, Randburg, Johannesburg	CONFIRMED (`knowledge.json` , workbook A). The feed never prints it
Phone	066 542 1522	CONFIRMED (`knowledge.json` , swingshack.co.za). The 9 June post offers "Call/whatsapp" on it
What it is, literally	An indoor golf club: coaching, club fitting, practice, social play and equipment retail, built on TrackMan. "South Africa's first and only true indoor golf club"	CONFIRMED internally (bible v1). For public copy see the "first and only" row in section 7
What it is not	Not a driving range. Not an arcade with golf screens. Not a country-club extension. Not a discount range. Not a sales floor pushing brands for margin	CONFIRMED (bible v1 sections 1 and 15)
Customer actions	Book a bay. Get fitted. Take a lesson. Join as a member. Play social golf	CONFIRMED (workbook A)
Instagram	`swingshack`	CONFIRMED (workbook O, `instagram.json` , all 789 audited posts)
Other channels	Facebook (community and events), Google Business Profile. TikTok not a priority. YouTube a candidate	CONFIRMED (workbook L, O)
Sister brand	Stick, under Stick Golf Group. Not named in Swing Shack copy	CONFIRMED

2. Language settings

Setting	Decision	Feed evidence	Status
Language variant (L1.1)	South African English, British spelling	"meters" 3 times and "metres" once. Typos: "preform", "Dont", "sneak peak", "Lets"	DRAFT
Serial comma (L2.7)	No	Not enough lists in the feed to say. Matches Stick	DRAFT
Quotation marks	Double, curly		DRAFT
Apostrophes (L2.3)	Curly	43 curly, 12 straight	DRAFT
Exclamation marks (L2.4)	0 in headlines. Max 1 per post	23 of the last 200 captions (12%). Whole feed: 246 of 764 (32%)	DRAFT
Em and en dashes (L2.2)	Never	4 captions contain an em dash and 1 an en dash	CONFIRMED rule
Ellipsis (L2.5)	Never	2 captions	CONFIRMED
ALL-CAPS lines (L2.6)	Never in captions. Template labels only	12 captions open on one	DRAFT
Unicode bold or italic letters	Never	10 captions	DRAFT (decision 12)
Number style (L3.1)	Numerals for data and money. Words one to nine in prose		DRAFT

Setting	Decision	Feed evidence	Status
Currency (L3.2)	`R7,999`. Always with the R. `399/pm` is not a price	See decision 8	DRAFT
Units (L3.3)	Metres, km/h	See decision 7	DRAFT
Dates (L3.4)	`28 February`. No ordinals	"28th of Feb", "till the 30 Nov", "1 November"	DRAFT
Times (L3.4)	24-hour, ranges with "to": `10:00 to 12:00`	"10am to 12pm"	DRAFT
Hook maximum (L5.1)	100 characters, then re-check against the live Instagram cut-off. Stick's limit is 80. Swing Shack's best one-line captions run to about 90	Median first line 62 characters, 90th percentile 147, in the last 200 captions. 111 of those 200 are a single line	DRAFT
Hashtags (L5.8)	0 to 3, last, CamelCase	See decision 4	DRAFT
Allowed hashtags	`#SwingShack` `#IndoorGolfJohannesburg` `#IndoorGolfSA` `#GolfJohannesburg` `#TrackMan` `#ClubFitting` `#GolfCoaching`	The seven most relevant of the feed's tags. Dropped: `#golf`, `#golflife`, `#coach`, `#golfaddict`, `#tech`, `#vibes`, `#kedezembaboss`	DRAFT
Emoji (L5.9)	Max 1, optional. Allowed: 🏌️ ⛳ 📍	See decision 3	DRAFT
Caps	Sentence case. `TrackMan`, `Swing Shack`, `Zen Swing Stage`	See section 3	DRAFT
Sign-off (L5.7)	None required. If used: `Real golf, indoors.`	See decision 5	DRAFT
Contact line	One CTA line, section 6		DRAFT

3. Name registry

Name	Write it as	Known wrong forms (seen in feed)	Notes
This brand	`Swing Shack`	`SwingShack` in 7 captions' prose (plus `#swingshack` in 55)	Handle `@swingshack` is fine as a handle
Fitting technology	`TrackMan`	`Trackman` in 3 captions, `TRACKMAN` in 2	12 captions spell it right in prose. Always as the tool, never the headline (workbook M)
Newest hardware	`TrackMan iO`		The workbook says first in South Africa. Confirm before saying "first"
Practice area	`Zen Swing Stage`	`ZEN STAGE`, `Zen Stage`	
Putters	`L.A.B. Golf` and `LA Golf` are two different brands	`LAB`, `LAB Golf`, `L.A.B Putters`, `LA golf`	Confirm both spellings with the suppliers
Grips	UNKNOWN	`Ripit`	Confirm with supplier (Stick's feed uses three spellings too)
Vice	`Vice Golf` first mention, `Vice` after		

Name	Write it as	Known wrong forms (seen in feed)	Notes
Takomo	`Takomo`		Valid models are listed in Stick's registry. Quarantined names must not be used: Takomo 101T-CB, 101T-MB, 201T, 101T Pro. The feed's "Takomo Ignis D1 Driver" (20 Oct 2025) is not in `knowledge.json`, so verify it
Other brands in the feed	Titleist (GTS, T250, Vokey), Scotty Cameron, Srixon, Callaway Quantum, Sub 70, Mileseey, Fujimoto, Avoda, Sausage Golf, Herschel		Stock status **UNKNOWN**. Check before any product post
Builder	ClubLab	Never named in the feed	Bible v1: "We are a ClubLab fitment centre and our builders treat the workshop like a lab"
People	Coach Catherine Lau (`Coach Cat` in captions). Dawid (coach, joined September). Divan. FJ (workshop). Dave (`@lampsdave`, appears on both brands' feeds)		Surnames for most **UNKNOWN**. May be named only with consent (decision 13)
Place	`Old Parktonian Sports Club, Bordeaux, Randburg`		
Terms	`indoor golf club`, `club fitting`, `club assessment`, `ball fitting`, `coaching session`	`studio`, `premier`	One term per thing

Stock words. `available at Swing Shack` is in the club now. `available through Swing Shack` is ordered in. `available for fitting at Swing Shack` means try it in a fitting. `available for pre-order`. Each needs a stock check in the Proof bank. If stock is unknown, say "DM us for pricing and stock", which the feed already does (3 captions).

4. Strategy core

All `CONFIRMED`, from Bible v1 and the workbook.

- **Purpose.** To make golf more enjoyable by removing the guesswork. Replace uncertainty with clarity, in a space that feels human, not clinical. (Workbook B.) Bible v1 gives a fuller statement: help every golfer play their own best golf through data-led coaching, fitting treated as science, and an experience that makes getting better feel good.
- **Core belief.** Golf is more fun when it makes sense.
- **Brand promise.** The ball speaks. Data confirms. Feel seals the deal.
- **Public tagline.** Real golf, indoors.
- **Internal mantra.** Real golf. Real data. Real welcome. (Not public.)
- **Quote used on the website.** The swing may lie, but the ball tells the truth.
- **Positioning.** Johannesburg's indoor golf club for people who care about their game but still want to enjoy it. TrackMan-powered fitting, coaching and practice with a relaxed, human atmosphere, so improvement feels exciting, not like homework.
- **Personality.** Precise, calm, confident, warm, credible, welcoming, current. "The sharp performance coach who is also a great host." Never snobbish, desperate, vague, corporate, condescending, stuffy or salesy.
- **Ambition.** The authority on measurement-led golf improvement in South Africa.
- **Audience, primary.** Serious golfers in Johannesburg who want to improve, defined by mindset not handicap: club golfers of 5 to 20 handicap, players who have plateaued, returning golfers, the indoor-curious.

- **Audience, secondary.** Social and casual golfers: social play, TrackMan games, group bookings, a way to play whatever the weather.
- **They already know:** indoor golf exists, TrackMan is a launch monitor, fitting probably helps, golf is hard. Do not explain what a simulator is.
- **They worry that:** indoor golf is a toy, the data is intimidating, fitting will be an upsell, they are not good enough, the numbers will confirm how bad they are, indoor swings do not transfer.
- **Never make them feel:** intimidated, patronised, sold to, judged, confused by data with no conclusion, that indoor golf is "less than" real golf, that improvement is homework.
- **The litmus test (bible v1 section 16).** Does this help the golfer get better? Is it honest and backed by data? Does it respect the player at any level? Does it treat the golfer as an individual? Would I be proud to say this is how Swing Shack behaves? When in doubt: warmth plus truth.
- **Messaging priority (workbook E).** 1. Golf is more fun when it makes sense. 2. Know your numbers. 3. Fitting first, brand second. 4. Tech serves the player. 5. Real golf, indoors.

5. Voice

5.1 Character

- **Voice in five words:** warm, knowledgeable, witty, useful, confident (workbook D). Bible v1 adds: clear, calm, precise, honest, welcoming. `CONFIRMED`.
- **If Swing Shack were a person:** the coach who greets you by name, shows you the number, tells you the truth kindly, and has you booked in for next week before you leave.
- **Point of view:** data is there to make golf make sense, not to make golfers feel small.
- **We are, but not:**
  - precise, but not clinical: a number always comes with its meaning.
  - warm, but not gushing: welcome without exclamation marks.
  - witty, but not a comedian: dry lines, not skits or puns on every post.
  - confident, but not boastful: we state what we can show.
  - a club, not a clubhouse with a velvet rope.

5.2 Voice dials

Dial	Setting	The rule that follows
Formality	2 of 5	Contractions are fine. No text-speak (`u` , `w us` , `lil` , `sesh`)
Humour	2 of 5	One dry beat at most. Never at the golfer's expense. Never on price
Boldness	3 of 5	State what the data shows. Never promise a result
Technicality	3 of 5	Max three numbers per post, each with its "so what" (workbook K). Lead with the golfer's outcome, not TrackMan
Warmth	4 of 5	Welcoming, never urgent. "Come and see what your swing says" beats "Limited time offer"
Energy	2 of 5	Calm. Exclamation marks are rare and genuine
Local flavour	3 of 5	Joburg is allowed to show: summer heat, highveld, Randburg. Not a braai ad

5.3 Tone shifts by situation

Situation	Tone	Length	Humour?	Opening line in the feed's best register
Product arrival	Plain and specific	15 to 30 words	A dry line if it earns it	`Titleist GTS is now available for fitting at Swing Shack.`
Fitting education	Patient, evidence-led	20 to 40 words	Rare	`Your driver can feel fine.`
Coaching	Direct, encouraging, one idea	15 to 30 words	Yes, dry	`A few small changes can save a lot of golf balls.`
Membership and packages	Clear, plain, complete	25 to 45 words	None	State what you get, then the price, then how to join
Offer, competition, code	Understated, complete	15 to 30 words	None	What, who, until when, how
Event or social	Warm and specific	20 to 40 words	Light	Date, time and place first
New team member	Warm, short	15 to 30 words	Light	`Dawid has joined the coaching team.`
Bad news (closure, delay, price change)	Plain, quick, no spin	10 to 25 words	None	Say what happened and what happens next
Reply to a happy comment	Short and human	5 to 20 words	Match theirs	Thank them, use their name if public
Reply to a complaint	Calm and specific, then private	15 to 40 words	None	`Sorry about that. Can you DM us the details so we can sort it?`
Reply to a question we cannot answer	Honest	10 to 25 words	None	`Good question. Let us check and come back to you today.`

5.4 Humour, slang and sensitive ground

- **Humour that works (from the feed):** "The woods are lovely this time of year. Still, probably better to stay out of them." · "Off-the-rack is fine for groceries. For clubs, let's aim a little higher." · "Golf is easier when the club is built around your swing, not someone else's spec sheet." Understatement, specific, golfer-aware.
- **Humour that does not:** stacked puns ("At a loss 'fore' words"), 🤣 as punctuation, "Hit bombs", jokes about golfers' ability.
- **Slang allowed (workbook D):** `stripe it`, `flush it`, `dialled in`, `scoring zone`. **Never:** `crushing it`, `beast mode`, `lit`, `bro`, `fam`, `sesh`, `lil`, `u`.
- **Profanity:** none (workbook D).
- **Local language:** Joburg context is welcome and natural. No forced slang.
- **Never joke about:** a golfer's handicap, swing, body, age or money. Do not address people by gender ("Ladies, this one's for you", 17 Oct) unless the event is genuinely for one group, and then say so plainly.

6. Lexicon

Signature lines

Line	Where it goes
`Real golf, indoors.`	The public tagline. Brand pieces, bios, optional sign-off

Line	Where it goes
`Golf is more fun when it makes sense.`	The belief. Education and brand posts. The workbook's hook pattern: "Golf is more fun when [specific problem]."
`The ball speaks. Data confirms. Feel seals the deal.`	The promise. Used sparingly, never as a sign-off
`The ball tells the truth.`	Coaching philosophy
`Fit first, brand second.`	Fitting rule (workbook E)
`Fit + Build = Truth`	Used in November 2025 as `#FitBuildTruth`. Keep only if the owners confirm

The workbook's six recurring properties (What Does Your Swing Say?, The 10-Ball Truth, Shack Sessions, The Truth About..., Golf Is More Fun When..., Before / After / Why) are valid titles once they are live. See decision 15.

Approved calls to action (L5.6)

One per caption. The "how" is part of the CTA.

CTA	Use for	Status
`Book a fitting. Link in bio.`	Fitting	**DRAFT** (3 captions)
`Book your fitting today.`	Fitting	**DRAFT** (the most frequent booking line)
`Book your coaching session.`	Coaching	**DRAFT**
`Book a club assessment.`	Assessment, only while live	**DRAFT**, offer status **UNKNOWN**
`DM us for price and details.`	Product posts without a price	**DRAFT** (8 captions)
`DM us for fitting details.`	Fitting-only products	**DRAFT** (4)
`DM us for pricing and stock.`	Stock unknown	**DRAFT** (3)
`Message us to order.`	Order-in items	**DRAFT**
`DM us to join.`	Membership	**DRAFT**
`Come try one at Swing Shack.`	Putters, grips, bags	**DRAFT**
`Book your fitting at Swing Shack.`	Fitting, in the brand's dry register	**DRAFT** (the 25 July caption)
`Book a club fitting. Link in bio.`	Fitting education	**DRAFT** (the 27 May caption)
`DM us to secure yours.`	Limited stock, only where the stock is real	**DRAFT** (the 10 June Srixon caption)

In the machine rules (kept in the repository) a `*` in a call to action means "any words", so `DM us to *.` covers `DM us to join.` and `DM us to secure yours.`

Workbook wording (Book a fitting, Book coaching, Book a bay, Join the club, Visit us) remains valid.

Banned for Swing Shack (adds to L7)

Phrase	Why
`guaranteed`, `up to N shots`, `as many as N`	Unsubstantiated performance claims (finding 1)
`Pros average ...`, any comparison to a tour or pro number	Not in the Proof bank
`Real South African results` followed by figures	Not in the Proof bank
`That's fact, not opinion`	A claim that must be backed, not asserted

Phrase	Why
`elevate`	In the third most-liked post of the year, and still banned (workbook D)
`unlock` , `journey`	Banned (workbook D)
`alert` , `NEW ARRIVAL ALERT` , `Grip upgrade alert`	Shouting
`Don't Miss Out` , `Limited time only`	The brand's offers are "welcoming, not urgent"
`We got you sorted` , `We've got u covered`	Filler and text-speak
`your one stop for all your golfing needs`	Corporate, passes the swap test for any shop
`indoor golf studio` , `premier`	The brand is a club
`perfect setup` , `perfect swing`	"The perfect X" is an impossible claim (workbook N)
`Ladies, this one's for you` , `Juniors, it's your turn to smash it`	Gendered or age-labelled address without a plain reason
`Hit bombs`	Slang that cheapens the product
`Stick`	Without approver sign-off

Watch words (max one per caption)

`premium` , `proper` , `clean` , `serious` , `sharp` .

Say this, not that

Say this	Not that	Why
`A fitting measures what your clubs do and matches them to your swing.`	`A proper club fit can unlock up to 25 meters`	No invented number
`Book a fitting at Swing Shack.`	`Don't Miss Out` 👊	One CTA, no pressure
`Membership gives you 4 free practice sessions a month, 25% off fittings and 15% off lessons.`	`For only 399/pm you get to enjoy some great perks`	Specific and complete
`Coach Catherine takes you through the flop shot.`	`Coach Cat takes us through a simple process on getting into one of the more challenging shots`	Plain and shorter
`Mileseey rangefinders are available through Swing Shack.`	`Hit bombs.`	Says what it is
`Come and see what your swing says.`	`Book NOW before your ball joins a search and rescue team` 😬	Welcoming, not urgent

7. Messaging and the Proof bank

Master message

Swing Shack makes golf more enjoyable by helping you understand your real swing, your real equipment and what to actually do next. `CONFIRMED` (workbook E).

Seasonal emphasis

Pre-season (January to March): "Start the season fitted." Winter (May to August): indoor golf peak, "Rain? Cold? Dark? Doesn't matter." Spring (September to October): equipment refresh, loft and lie checks. Gift season (November to December): vouchers, corporate events, social play. `CONFIRMED` (workbook E).

Proof bank

`CONFIRMED` rows can be used. `DRAFT` rows need a check on the day. `UNKNOWN` means silence.

Fact (as it may be written)	Value	Source	Verified	Expires	Status
Location	Old Parktonian Sports Club, 1 Garden Road, Bordeaux, Randburg, Johannesburg	`knowledge.json`	2026-09-23	never	CONFIRMED
Phone	066 542 1522	`knowledge.json`	2026-09-23	re-check yearly	CONFIRMED
Booking page	swingshack.co.za/bookings/	`knowledge.json`	2026-09-23	re-check monthly	CONFIRMED
Setup	4 TrackMan bays including TrackMan iO. 400+ world courses. Zen Swing Stage	swingshack.co.za	2026-09-23	6 months	CONFIRMED
Services	Fitting (driver, iron, wedge, putter, full bag), coaching, practice, social play, retail	`knowledge.json`	2026-09-23	6 months	CONFIRMED
Coaching format	Limited to three key feels per session. Video analysis and TrackMan data after each lesson	swingshack.co.za	2026-09-23	6 months	CONFIRMED
Fitting philosophy	Brand-agnostic. Fit the player, not the player to the club	Bible v1 section 7.2	2026-09-23	never	CONFIRMED
Builds	ClubLab handles builds to the fitted spec: loft, lie, length, swing weight, shaft, grip	Bible v1 section 7.3	2026-09-23	never	CONFIRMED
Float payment option	Yes	swingshack.co.za	2026-09-23	6 months	CONFIRMED
Membership benefits	4 free practice sessions a month, 25% off fittings, 15% off lessons	Workbook C, feed 10 Jun	2026-09-23	with price	CONFIRMED. The 10 Jun post also lists monthly workshops and discounts on selected balls and gloves: DRAFT
Membership price	R2,475 for the rest of 2026 (10 Jun) or 399/pm (26 Aug)	Feed	not verified		UNKNOWN. The two conflict (decision 6)
Monthly packages	I Dabble R1,800 (unlimited practice). Birdie Hunter R2,300 (1 lesson and unlimited practice). I Am Golf R2,850 (weekly lesson and unlimited practice), all per month	Feed 11 to 13 Jun	not verified		DRAFT
Coaching packages	1 session R820. 3 sessions R2,350. 5 sessions R3,850. 10 sessions R7,200	Feed 14 Jun	not verified		DRAFT
Intro session R250		Feed 30 Mar, in the all-caps batch	not verified		UNKNOWN

Fact (as it may be written)	Value	Source	Verified	Expires	Status
Brands stocked	Takomo, Vice Golf, L.A.B. Putters, LA Golf, Miura, Titleist, Callaway, Ping, Cobra, Mizuno, Avoda (arriving), Fujimoto (arriving), boutique brands	swingshack.co.za FAQ	2026-09-23	3 months	**CONFIRMED** (spellings: decision 17)
Further brands in the feed	Ripit, Mileseey, Scotty Cameron, Srixon, Sub 70, Sausage Golf, Herschel	Feed	not verified	per post	**DRAFT**
Free club assessment	A look at the real specs of your clubs	Feed, 8 captions, Oct 2025 to Jan 2026	stale		**UNKNOWN** whether live
Code `FITTING15`	15% off all fittings, until end of May 2026	Feed 30 Apr		expired	**EXPIRED**
"First and only true indoor golf club in South Africa"		Bible v1, workbook	internal		**DRAFT** for public use. No third-party proof in the repo. L4.2 needs evidence a stranger could check
Phone	066 542 1522, also written as `0665421522` in captions from 2023	`knowledge.json`, feed	2026-09-23		**CONFIRMED**
WhatsApp +27 76 669 0743	Offered in Catherine Lau's posts, Aug 2025	Feed	not verified		**UNKNOWN**. Whose number, and is it live?
Membership price history	2025: R3,850 a year or R350 a month (Dec 2024). 2026: R2,475 for the rest of 2026 (Jun), 399/pm (Aug)	Feed	not verified		**UNKNOWN**. The current price is not recorded
TPI assessment	A golf-specific body assessment, offered from January 2025	Feed	not verified		**DRAFT**. Confirm it is still offered
Number of courses	Grew from 97 (2023) to 280 (Dec 2023) to 350 (Oct 2024). `knowledge.json` says 400+	Feed, `knowledge.json`	2026-09-23	quarterly	**CONFIRMED** at 400+. Never quote an older number
Opening hours					**UNKNOWN**. They have changed: 9 to 9 six days (2023), Tue to Fri from 6 am and Mondays added (Nov 2023)
Priced item	Srixon Limited Edition US Open stand bag with three headcovers, R7,999, two available (also on Stick's feed the same week)	Feed 9 to 11 Jun	stale	expired	**DRAFT**. Historical only
"391,000 strokes" in 2025		Feed 23 Dec 2025	not verified		**UNKNOWN**. Not a claim to repeat without the data
Staff	Coach Catherine Lau. Dawid (coaching). Divan. FJ (workshop)	Feed	not verified	per post	**DRAFT**
Every performance figure listed in "Read this first"					**UNKNOWN**. Do not use

Fact (as it may be written)	Value	Source	Verified	Expires	Status
Number of members, fittings, customers or improvements					UNKNOWN. Never state one

Banned fabrications (`knowledge.json`): no "90% of golfers" or "30-metre accuracy" stats, no fake TrackMan numbers, no fake fitting outcomes, no fake member counts, no "12-shot improvement". The 12 captions in the feed that state a performance figure are listed in the findings above. A 13th, "391,000 strokes" (23 Dec 2025), is a usage total with no source.

Offer register

Offer	What	Who	Ends	How to claim	Approved wording	Status
Club assessment	A look at the real specs of your set	Anyone with a set	UNKNOWN	DM or link in bio	`Book a club assessment.`	UNKNOWN, confirm live
Membership	See Proof bank			DM us to join		Price UNKNOWN (decision 6)

Offers feel welcoming, not urgent (workbook K). Membership should feel like joining a club, not signing up for a deal. Scarcity only when true: bay availability, membership windows, stock.

8. Caption lanes

Lanes combine the workbook's six properties with the lanes the feed actually runs. Lane counts come from a keyword pass over the last 200 captions and are approximate.

```
LANE: Product arrival (about 66 of the last 200)
Purpose:            Tell golfers a thing is here and why it is worth a fitting
Anatomy:            Hook (the product) / one line of character / CTA
Length:             15 to 30 words, 3 to 5 lines (feed median 20.5)
Hook patterns:      "[Brand] [product] available at Swing Shack." / "[Brand]. Now at Swing Shack." / "[Short
line]."
CTA:                DM us for price and details. / Book a fitting.
Voice dials:        Humour 2, technicality 2
Approved example:   10 June Srixon bag
Rejected example:   "Grip upgrade alert 🔮 Ripit grips now at Swing Shack..." (alert, emoji)
Notes:              Stock check required. Never reuse a line used on Stick within 90 days. Tie the product to a
fitting, the numbers or the bay, not just "it is here"

LANE: Fitting and TrackMan education (about 34)
Purpose:            Make golf make sense
Anatomy:            Hook / what the data shows / what to do / CTA
Length:             20 to 40 words
Hook patterns:      "[Something a golfer thinks]." / "Your [club] can feel fine."
CTA:                Book a club fitting. Link in bio.
Approved example:   27 May "Your driver can feel fine."
Notes:              Max three numbers, each with a "so what". Every figure from the Proof bank

LANE: Coaching (about 43, mostly Coach Cat clips)
Purpose:            One useful idea, a face the audience knows
Anatomy:            Hook / the idea / CTA
Length:             15 to 30 words
CTA:                Book your coaching session.
Approved example:   20 July "A few small changes can save a lot of golf balls."
Notes:              The caption adds what the clip cannot. Name the coach, with consent. Retire "Coaching helps!"
and puns

LANE: Membership, packages and prices (about 12)
Purpose:            Make the options clear
Anatomy:            Hook / what you get / price / CTA
Length:             25 to 45 words
CTA:                DM us to join.
Notes:              Plain text only, no Unicode bold. Price format R2,475. One source of truth for prices

LANE: Competitions and giveaways (about 10)
Anatomy:            What you can win / how to enter / closes on / winner announcement
CTA:                Enter in store or DM us.
Notes:              Terms complete (L4.3). Winners named only with consent

LANE: Events, community and seasonal (about 10)
Examples:           Driver Clinic, Demo Day, Members Social, radio spot, merch, holiday series
Anatomy:            What / when / where / how to join
Length:             20 to 40 words

LANE: The series the feed already runs
Examples:           Build of the Week (24), "Did you know" (13), Tip of the Week (9), Myth vs Reality (6), Shack
Labs (4), course-of-the-week "now on TrackMan" (11), "Big week at Swing Shack" (10)
Status:             The old voice files ban "Did you know". The feed ran it for five months. Decide per series
whether to keep it (decision 15)
Notes:              A series earns a title line, a fixed anatomy and a cadence, as the workbook's properties
would

LANE: Free assessment and offers (about 14)
Notes:              Run only when the offer is live. State the offer in the Offer register

LANE: What Does Your Swing Say? / The 10-Ball Truth / Shack Sessions / The Truth About... / Golf Is More Fun
When... / Before, After, Why
Status:             Defined in workbook J. No captions in the feed name them (decision 15)
Notes:              If live, add a title line and the minimum cadence the workbook sets (weekly, twice a month,
weekly, 2 to 3 a month, weekly, weekly)
```

9. Channel rules

Workbook L, with the feed's habits noted. `DRAFT`.

Channel	Role	Formats	Length	Hashtags	Tags	CTA	Reply voice	Avoid
Instagram feed	Authority and education hub	Carousel (education), static (brand, product), Reel cross-posts	Per lane	0 to 3, last	Partners with permission	Per lane	Short, human	Catalogue posts with no reason to care. Overly technical with no conclusion
Instagram Stories	Fast texture: bay moments, polls, drops	Stories-native	1 to 2 lines per frame	None	Stickers fine	Book, Message	Same	Over-designed slides, more than 4 to 5 per topic
Reels	Engagement and proof	9:16, 15 to 60 seconds, branded intro and outro	Caption per lane	0 to 3		Book a fitting, Book a bay	Same	No branded frame, talking head with no b-roll, no captions on screen
Facebook	Community and events	Feed, events, Reels	Per lane	None		Learn more, Join, Book	Same	Reel cross-posts with no context
Paid ads	Distribution	Feed, Reel, Story, carousel	Per brief	None		Book, Join	n/a	Cheap traffic with no purpose. Ad creative is real human video (Christelle's rule, project memory)
Website	Conversion and search	Service pages, booking engine, campaign pages	Per page	n/a		Book a fitting, Book coaching, Join	n/a	Generic pages without the Swing Shack voice, no UTM tracking
Google Business Profile	Local search	Posts, Q&A, photos	1 to 3 sentences	None		Call, Visit, Message	Same, within a day	Not posting updates, unanswered Q&A
WhatsApp	The 9 June post offers "Call/whatsapp" on 066 542 1522							Confirm it is monitored before promoting it

10. Customer conversation

- **Who replies:** UNKNOWN. Name one person and a backup.
- **Speed:** "A slow response is a broken promise. Speed to lead matters every day." (Bible v1 14.4.) Within a working day at the latest for DMs and comments. `DRAFT`.
- **First DM reply:** names what they asked about and the next step. "Hi [name], thanks for asking about [x]. [Answer.] Want to book a fitting or come and have a look?"
- **Staff behaviour that the brand promises (bible v1 14):** greet within seconds, use their name, ask before telling, never over-promise results, set the next step before they leave, ask for the review.

- **Complaints:** acknowledge, take it private, fix it. Never argue in public or delete a fair complaint.
- **Escalate to the owner:** pricing disputes, injury, legal threats, press, anything about a named person, any complaint about a fitting result.
- **Reply examples:** section 5.3.

11. Visual identity

Update, 2026-10-15: Swing Shack's colours, fonts and logo are now settled by the designer's branding document (5 pages, received 13 October, added to the repo on PR #88 as `swing-shack/brand-guide/swingshack-branding-document.pdf`). Where it disagrees with the workbook or the renderer's files, the designer's document wins. Source: `CampaignOS/decisions/everything-runs-through-brand-bibles-2026-10-12.md` in the wiki.

Element	The designer's branding document	Status
Main colours	`#1C1C1C`, `#404040`, `#7C7C7C`, `#FFFFFF`	CONFIRMED
Accents	`#74CC46` green, `#63A3EF` blue, `#E27124` orange, `#8F4BF9` purple. "Additional accent colours to be used with discretion"	CONFIRMED
Fonts	Logo: "SWING" in Aktiv Grotesk XBold Italic, "SHACK" in Calgary Script OT (-25 tracking). Social: Avenir Next Heavy Italic, Avenir Next Italic, Aktiv Grotesk XBold Italic. Website: Poppins Bold headers, Roboto Regular body	CONFIRMED
Logo use	Dark logo on white. White logo on dark grey and on photos	CONFIRMED
Design cues	Photo backgrounds, originals when possible. Gradient overlays from a black base to the accent colour. The logo's border frame as a design element	CONFIRMED

The workbook's navy `#0F1923`, gold `#D4AF37`, teal and Inter are wrong for Swing Shack, and so is the renderer's old teal and amber primary. The table below is the earlier comparison, kept for the record. Its layout and devices rows still stand.

Element	Workbook F says	Renderer uses	Source of truth
Primary	Deep navy `#0F1923`, warm white `#F5F3ED`	Deep teal `#0F766E`, amber `#F59E0B`. Its own source field says "visual best-guess; needs Drive validation"	UNKNOWN. Workbook S says the hex values are "inferred from the brand strategy document and website"
Accent	Gold `#D4AF37`, teal `#2A9D8F`	Tokens measured from older posts	UNKNOWN
Backgrounds	`#0A0E14`		
Fonts	Inter, JetBrains Mono (data)	Montserrat Italic	UNKNOWN
Logo	Clear space = height of the S. Never recolour, gradient, shadow or stretch. Min 24 px digital, 15 mm print	`swing-shack/logo.png` is a 64 by 64 plain white square, not a logo	Need the real logo files
Layout	Text in top or bottom 30%, never over a face or product. Logo top-left on feed, top-right on Stories. Central 80% safe zone for Reels	Per template	CONFIRMED (workbook F)
Devices	"What Does Your Swing Say?" title frame, TrackMan data overlay (one number, one conclusion), before and after split, 10-ball counter, "Golf Is More Fun When..." statement card		CONFIRMED

12. Photography and imagery

`CONFIRMED` from workbook G and N, plus Christelle's rules.

- **Look:** high contrast, deep blacks, slightly desaturated, cool shadows, neutral mids, slightly warm highlights. Never oversaturated.
- **Location:** the Swing Shack studio is the location: bays with the TrackMan screen glowing, the Zen Swing Stage, the workshop bench, signage on a dark wall. Never a golf course as the main setting.
- **People:** real golfers, coaches, fitters. The best single image is a golfer reacting to a TrackMan result.
- **Real over generated:** never render a fake bay, a fake TrackMan screen or a fake product. A TrackMan screen shows real data or none. (Workbook N: "TrackMan screen with invented or impossible data" is a listed rejected look.)
- **Rejected looks:** clinical white lab, tartan and leather, nightclub lighting, generic range stock photos, brochure poses, anything that makes indoor golf look like a video game, AI text or hallucinated product details.
- **Image generation:** only for genuinely new looks that photography cannot supply. Never for venue, product, people or data.

13. Product and asset fidelity

`CONFIRMED` (workbook H). Geometry, colour, finish, markings, logo placement, proportions, handedness, model names and packaging are never altered in any render or edit. Product colours are exact. Real photos live under `images/` (10 of the 14 venue photos are misnamed HEIC files the composer cannot open).

14. Templates and deterministic layers

Measured templates: `fitting-headline`, `service-promo`, `did-you-know`, `discount-code`, `lesson-corner`, `price-list`, `price-package`, `sale-offer`, `zen-venue-promo` (`templates/`, `visual-spec/archetypes.json`).

Gap	Effect
`ss-service-promo` has no partner-logo zone	Real Services posts put a partner mark beside the lockup
`ss-did-you-know`, `ss-price-package`, `ss-price-list`, `ss-sale-offer`, `ss-service-promo` cannot compose copy filled to their own declared limits	Write under the limit, not at it. `ss-price-list` overflows today
`ss-did-you-know`	The old `voice/tone-rules.md` says "Never start with 'Did you know...'" and calls it Stick voice, yet a Swing Shack template exists and the feed ran a 13-caption "Did you know" series (23 Aug 2025 to 21 Jan 2026). The old rule is wrong about the feed. Decide which is right
`ss-discount-code`, `ss-sale-offer`	Fine for real offers with full terms. Not for "Don't Miss Out"

- Logo, price, date, legal copy and CTA come from the deterministic layer, never an image model.
- Run `/render-post --list` for current templates and limits before writing on-image copy.

15. Reference library

Golden examples

Real captions from the feed. Tags and emoji trimmed to fit the settings.

#	Date and lane	Caption	Why it works	Rules
1	25 Jul, Fitting	`Off-the-rack is fine for groceries. / For clubs, let's aim a little higher. / Book your fitting at Swing Shack.`	Dry, specific, respects the reader, one CTA	L6.1, L6.2, L5.6
2	23 Jul, Coaching	`The woods are lovely this time of year. / Still, probably better to stay out of them. / Book your coaching session.`	Wit that is specific to golf, then a clear next step	L6.2, L5.6
3	20 Jul, Coaching	`A few small changes can save a lot of golf balls. / Book your coaching session now.`	One idea, shows the benefit, no numbers needed	L5.2, L6.1
4	21 Jul, Fitting	`Golf is easier when the club is built around your swing, not someone else's spec sheet. / Book your fitting.`	States the belief in the brand's own terms	L6.2, L5.6
5	27 May, Education	`Your driver can feel fine. / But TrackMan shows what ball flight hides: spin rate, launch angle, strike pattern and dispersion. / That is the difference between guessing and fitting properly. / Book a club fitting. Link in bio.`	TrackMan as the tool, the golfer's outcome as the point, four things named, one CTA with its how	L6.1, L4.1, L5.6
6	10 Jun, Product and price	`This one will not sit quietly in the corner. / Limited Edition Srixon US Open Stand Bag. / Three matching headcovers included. / R7,999. / Only two available. / DM us to secure yours.`	A line only this brand would say, price and scarcity stated plainly, one CTA	L4.3, L3.2, L5.6
7	12 Oct, Product	`Camo has entered the chat. / New Herschel golf bags are now at Swing Shack. / Plenty of character. Plenty of storage. / DM us for pricing and stock.`	Light humour, plain facts. Remove the Unicode bold from the first line	L6.2, L5.6

Rejected examples

#	Date	Caption (shortened)	Rules broken	The fix
1	20 Nov 2025	`87% of golfers who get fit lower their handicap. That's fact, not opinion. Your game deserves equipment that performs to your potential. Book your fitting today.`	Unsourced statistic (L4.1), `potential` (L7), `That's fact, not opinion` , emoji at the front	`A fitting matches your clubs to your swing. Book your fitting.`
2	23 Oct 2025	`Fitted clubs can take up to 5 shots off your game guaranteed!`	`guaranteed` (L4.1), "up to" claim (L3.5), exclamation	Delete the claim. Say what a fitting measures
3	30 Mar	`FROM CONFUSED GOLFER TO CONFIDENT STRIKER. Real South African results: Club speed 142km/h to 158km/h, Distance 165m to 265m, Accuracy +32%. R820 full TrackMan coaching session.`	Invented results (L4.1), ALL CAPS (L2.6), "studio" (decision 9), `confused golfer` mocks the reader (L6.6)	A real client result with consent and data, or nothing
4	1 Apr	`SWING SPEED: 83 MPH / Pros average 112 mph. TrackMan found you could gain 29 meters.`	Units mixed (L3.3), unsourced comparison, `meters` spelling, ALL CAPS	Real data from a real session, one unit system
5	10 Jun	`R2,475 for the rest of 2026` and the whole post in mathematical bold	Unicode letters are unreadable to screen readers and unsearchable (L5.12 spirit)	Plain text. Bold is not available in captions, so use line breaks and capitals for the first letters only
6	26 Nov 2025	`Is your budget looking a lil tight 🤑 We've got u covered with discounts on your golfing needs.`	Text-speak (L1.4), emoji, no offer terms (L4.3)	State the offer: what, who, until when, how
7	21 Apr	`Built to preform.`	Typo (L1.3)	`Built to perform.`
8	9 Jun	`Srixon Stand Bags Available 🏌️ / R7999.00 / Head covers included 🔥 / Only Two left 💸 / Call/whatsapp us on 066 542 1522 / Dont Miss Out 👊`	Currency format (L3.2), emoji (L5.9), typo, `Don't Miss Out` , capitalisation (L2.6)	See golden example 6

#	Date	Caption (shortened)	Rules broken	The fix
9	24 Jun	`Want to elevate your golfing game with something cool😎`	`elevate` (L7). This is the third most-liked post in the feed, which shows engagement is not a measure of voice	`Learn and practise on the Zen Swing Stage. Only at Swing Shack.`
10	26 Aug	`For only 399/pm you get to enjoy some great perks from discounts to members clinics and more!`	No currency symbol (L3.2), vague perks (L6.1), conflicts with the R2,475 post (decision 6), exclamation	List the perks and the real price
11	26 May to 5 Aug	20 captions with a line of copy that also appears on Stick's feed (24 counting calls to action)	L6.2 across brands (finding 3)	A brand-specific reason in every product post
12	17 Oct 2025	`Ladies, this one's for you 💕 Join our Driver Clinic on 1 November and get exclusive discounts on the day 💸`	Gendered address, vague "exclusive discounts" (L4.3), emoji	`Driver Clinic, 1 November, [time]. [What it is]. DM us to book.`

16. Feed truth and reconciliation

Counted 2026-10-13 from `feedback/instagram-audit.json`: 789 posts (401 videos, 326 images, 62 carousels), 764 with a caption, 16 December 2022 to 13 October 2026. The account is `swingshack`. Insights came back for 679 of the 789 posts; 110 did not (88 of them videos). Unless a row says otherwise, figures below are for the last 200 posts (10 October 2025 to 13 October 2026).

Measure	Before 10 Oct 2025 (564 captions)	Last 12 months (200)	Whole feed (764)
Emoji	269 (48%)	131 (66%)	400 (52%)
Hashtags	305 (54%), 139 with five or more	87 (44%), 32 with five or more	392 (51%), 171 with five or more
Exclamation marks	223 (40%)	23 (12%)	246 (32%)
Em dashes	68	4	72
Unicode bold	0	10	10
Median words, excluding hashtags	27	19	24
Likes per post	8.4	7.0	8.1

Question	The bible says	The feed shows	Decision
Voice	Warm, calm, precise, "sharp coach and great host"	Four registers in 12 months, section below	Bible v1 (decision 2)
Emoji	"Occasional and intentional"	131 of 200 captions, median 2, 41 with 3 or more	Max 1 (decision 3)
Hashtags		87 captions, 32 with 5 or more, 19 with the generic trio	0 to 3 (decision 4)
Exclamation marks	"Single… only in genuine enthusiasm"	23 captions	Keep rare
Em dashes	Banned	4 captions, plus 1 en dash	Remove

Question	The bible says	The feed shows	Decision
Tagline and sign-off	"Real Golf, Indoors" and "Golf is more fun when it makes sense"	`Real golf` in 1, the belief line in 0	Decision 5
Statistics and guarantees	"Every recommendation has a number behind it". No fake stats	12 captions state a performance figure, 1 of them with "guaranteed"	Retire (finding 1)
Caption length	Short to medium	Median 19 words (excluding hashtags). 111 of 200 are one line	Per lane
CTA	Book a fitting, Book coaching, Book a bay, Join the club, Visit us	`book` in 46, `DM` in 42, `link in bio` in 5	Section 6
Lane mix	Six workbook properties	Product arrival 66, coaching 43, fitting and TrackMan education 34, membership and prices 12, competitions 10, events 10, free assessment 8	Section 8
Workbook properties	Weekly and twice-monthly cadences	0 of 764 captions name any. The feed's own series are listed in finding 2	Decision 15
Offers	"Welcoming, not urgent"	Black Friday (2), code `FITTING15`, 10 competition captions, `Don't Miss Out`	Decision 11
Name spelling	`TrackMan`, `Swing Shack`	`Trackman` 3, `TRACKMAN` 2, `SwingShack` 7	Section 3
"Club" or "studio"	"Indoor golf club"	"indoor golf studio" in 2	Decision 9
Sister-brand copy		26 shared lines, 21 of them copy and 5 calls to action, 26 May to 5 Aug	Decision 10
Contradictions in the old files		README: "Not for first-timers", bible v1: "Welcome every level". `tone-rules.md`: "not a joke brand", workbook: "wry", and the Shack Sessions property is "jokes, reactions". `tone-rules.md` bans "Did you know", yet the template `ss-did-you-know` exists and the feed ran a 13-caption "Did you know" series (23 Aug 2025 to 21 Jan 2026). README: "premium", bible v1: "not aspirational". README: age 28 to 55, no source	This bible supersedes `voice/`, `copy/headlines.md` and `README.md` once confirmed
Performance		Likes average 8.1 a post across the whole feed (7.0 in the last 12 months). The most liked are ambassador announcements (82, 80 and 76 likes, Mar to May 2025), not copy. In the last year: 29 Sep (45, a walk-through video), 23 Sep (45, a radio spot), 24 Jun (42, the "elevate" caption)	Engagement is not a measure of voice. The workbook says weight saves, shares, DMs and bookings, which the audit does not carry

Where the feed has been. - **Dec 2022 to 2023, the launch era.** A first-person coach voice ("DM me", "We are OPEN!!"), FlightScope and E6 simulators, long hashtag walls, events, a lesson package for R1,999, and "97 courses". TrackMan iO arrives in late October 2023 and the voice turns to the NEXT Golf Tour. - **2024.** Brand-by-brand one-liners ("Experience precision engineering with the Titleist driver", "Trust Miura irons to bring unparalleled performance to every swing"), then Tip of the Week, Build of the Week, Myth vs Reality and monthly free clinics. The first unsupported statistics appear in February. - **2025.** Float finance (February), TPI assessments (January to August), ambassador profiles, the Golf Day (22 May, sold out), "Swing Shack Steve", an AI news anchor, and from August the "Did you know" and Shack Labs series. A new coach, Catherine Lau, starts on 1 September. - **October 2025 to now, four registers:** 1. **October 2025 to January 2026:** promotional and emoji-heavy. Puns, "alert", exclamation, "Black Friday deals have landed", competitions, and a second run of unsupported statistics. 2. **30 March to 14 April 2026:** a batch of all-caps "data cards" with invented results, in a voice that does not appear before or after. They read as one generated set. 3. **20 April to August:** plain

product arrivals ("Avoda now at Swing Shack. Book your fitting...", "Titleist GTS is now available for fitting"), and from May a measured "Book a Fitting. Link in bio." education set. This is the closest the feed gets to the bible. 4. **July onward:** short dry lines with one CTA ("Off-the-rack is fine for groceries...") alongside video clips with five generic hashtags.

The best writing in the feed is in register 4 and the plainer half of register 3. They are the model. The 2024 brand one-liners and the all-caps data cards are the two stretches most unlike the brand.

17. Governance

- **Change process:** propose in the wiki or a pull request, the approver says yes in the current message, the change is logged below.
- **Who may publish without review:** product arrivals and coaching clips that pass the Gate with no hard fails and 12 or more of 16, with every fact `CONFIRMED` in the Proof bank. Offers, competitions, prices, anything naming a person and any performance claim need approver review.
- **Across the two brands:** a product post for Swing Shack and Stick must not share a full line within 90 days. Each states a reason specific to its brand: at Swing Shack, how it connects to fitting, the numbers or the bay. At Stick, why it is here. The Gate's swap test is run twice: with a competitor's name and with the sister brand's.
- **Where this is the source of truth:** copy rules, names, facts and lanes. Where it disagrees with `voice/`, `copy/` or `README.md`, this wins once confirmed.
- **Upstream sources:** Bible v1, Brand Essentials and the workbook. If they change, this file changes.

Change log

Date	Section	Change	Approved by
2026-10-13	all	First draft from the template. Swing Shack feed audit pulled and measured for the first time	pending
2026-10-13	header, 1, 16, 8, 14	Corrected the same day. The first draft treated a two-page pull (200 posts) as the whole feed. The audit holds 789 posts back to December 2022. Counts are now scoped to the last 200 posts, with whole-feed figures added, the older 564 captions read, the feed's own series recorded, and the "Did you know" finding corrected	pending

Open questions

Question	Owner	By
Decisions 1 to 17 at the top	Christelle, then Hermanus Kriel	
Did the published statistics come from real data?	Christelle with Hermanus Kriel	
Do the six workbook properties run as video titles?	Christelle	
Which membership price is current?	Christelle	
Opening hours	Christelle	
Is the free club assessment live?	Christelle	
Who replies to DMs and comments? Is WhatsApp monitored?	Christelle	
Confirm colours, fonts and logo files (section 11)	Christelle, designer	
Confirm supplier spellings (section 3)	Christelle	
Consent for named members, winners and staff	Christelle	

CHAPTER E

The Bag Drop

Brand bible, draft 1

Written 2026-10-13 from: the workbook's Bag Drop section, which records the owners' "bag drop brand and sales strategy 2026 to 2028 v2" (`swing-shack/workbook-source.txt`); the live store at `thebagdrop.co.za` (home page, refund policy, product pages and the public product list, all read on 2026-10-13); and all 33 posts on the Instagram account `the_bagdrop_za` (5 June to 9 August 2026), pulled on 2026-10-13 through the Graph API's public-account lookup with no insights. The old repo files (`README.md` , `voice/` , `copy/` , `knowledge.json` , `bible-visual.json`) were read and are treated as evidence of what the repo believes, not as sources. Every count below was run on 2026-10-13.

Status: `DRAFT` . Nothing here is `CONFIRMED` unless a source is named beside it. The approver has not signed it.

Read this first: the repo describes a different business

1. **The repo's Bag Drop files describe something that is not this store.** They say Bag Drop is a service where members leave their golf bag at Swing Shack, runs a Thursday member social, is a "sub-brand of Swing Shack" whose bookings "route through Swing Shack", and speaks in a warm community voice. Their calls to action are `Drop your bag with us → swingshack.co.za` and `Member social every Thursday. Join us` . The owners' strategy and the live site describe an **online store for demo and pre-owned golf gear**, at `thebagdrop.co.za` , with national shipping, curated drops, condition grades and a 30-day return policy. Not one of the 33 Instagram captions mentions a Thursday, a member, a social, or dropping a bag. The workbook warns about a related trap: the domain `bagdrop.co.za` is "a Cape Town luggage storage company". Anything the system writes from the old files sends customers to the wrong website and talks about a service this store does not offer. I found no evidence that a bag-storage service exists. The owners should confirm that, and if one does, it needs its own name. `knowledge.json` records the Thursday social as "promoted from" the same README and CTA files, so it has no independent source.
2. **Colours and fonts have three different answers, and none of them is confirmed.** The repo says warm orange `#F4A261` and deep teal-navy `#264653` . The workbook says charcoal `#121212` , off-white, lime `#C9EF62` and amber `#F2A541` , with Inter, and says "not warm/fuzzy". The live site is a light page with navy and sage-green type, in Montserrat. Section 11.
3. **The strategy's "trust layer" is only partly in place.** Condition grades exist on 71 of the 144 products as a dropdown (A on 53, B on 19, New on 3). The median product has one photo, 15 have none, and the strategy promises 4 to 6 angles for every item. The home page shows no Drop Alerts sign-up, and no caption mentions a sold item. Captions use "Demo" and "mint" as conditions, which are not on the site's scale.
4. **The feed is two months quiet and the store is not.** Last post 9 August 2026 (65 days ago). The store changed its catalogue this morning. The account has 183 followers and 33 posts. Only 4 of 33 captions state a product price, while the strategy says "Never make the customer DM to ask", and 11 of the 16 June captions end on a version of "Message us for current stock".
5. **Bag Drop cannot publish on its own yet.** `data/integrations/bag-drop/instagram.json` says `configured: false` with no account id. The wiki records that no Postiz key exists for Bag Drop, so a Bag Drop post would go out through Stick's channel.

Decisions needed before this can be marked CONFIRMED

#	Decision	Recommendation	Evidence
1	**Replace the repo's Bag Drop identity.** Confirm no bag-storage service exists, then retire the old README, `voice/`, `copy/`, `knowledge.json` and `bible-visual.json` in favour of this bible.	Yes. Until then, do not generate Bag Drop copy from the old files.	Finding 1 above
2	**The name.**	`The Bag Drop` in full at first mention, `Bag Drop` after. `BagDrop` and `Bagdrop` only in the web address.	Workbook A: "Bag Drop". Refund policy and Instagram name: "The Bag Drop". Site title and hero: "BagDrop", "Bagdrop". Logo: "BAGDROP"
3	**The master line.** Four are in use.	Pick one. Recommendation: `Good gear doesn't need to be new.` as the belief, and the bio line `Demo clubs, used golf gear and the essentials worth carrying. Quality kit. Better value.` as the description.	Workbook B: belief "Good gear doesn't need to be new", promise "Great golf gear, ready for another round". Home page: "Club upgrades don't need to cost an arm and a leg". Workbook S asks for one line
4	**Colours, fonts and logo.**	Take the designer's files, or decide that the live site is the source of truth. Do not recolour from any table here.	Section 11
5	**The condition scale.**	The site's `A`, `B`, `New`. Retire `Demo` and `mint` as conditions. The owners must write what A and B mean.	Site option values; feed uses `Demo`, `New`, `B`, "mint condition"
6	**Price format.**	`R6,500` in captions. The site shows `R 6,500.00`, which is a Shopify default and could be changed.	Feed: `R8 500`, `R5000`, `R7500`, `R5999`, `R500`
7	**"Second-hand".**	Retire it. Use `pre-owned` and `demo`. Allow `used` only where the site or policy already says it.	Workbook D lists "second-hand" as avoid. 8 captions use it. 0 use `pre-owned`
8	**Promoting Swing Shack and Stick.** `R500 off a fitting` is a real cross-offer.	Allowed when the approver says yes, with the offer's terms, and with the names written as `Swing Shack` and `Stick`.	22 and 25 June, 30 July. The old README bans cross-brand mentions. The captions write `SwingShack or Stick.paarl`
9	**Offers and shipping.**	Record each offer's terms in the Proof bank before it runs. Shipping rates are not on any page.	"Free shipping until 30 July" and "Free delivery... while the specials last"
10	**Trade-ins.**	Do not mention until the owners confirm the service and its terms.	8 August: "aggressively taking trade-ins". No page mentions it
11	**Drop Alerts.**	Do not use as a call to action until a sign-up exists.	The strategy calls it "the recurring relationship engine". No sign-up on the home page
12	**SOLD proof.**	Show it only for real sales, with the customer's consent if a person or parcel label is visible.	Strategy: "OUT THE DOOR". No captions show it
13	**Which voice.**	The first week's dry voice. Retire the August hype voice.	Section 16
14	**Handles.**	Record `the_bagdrop_za`, the Facebook page `The Bag Drop` and TikTok `@the.bag.drop.southafrica`.	Workbook O guessed `@bagdrop` or `@thebagdrop`. Both are wrong
15	**The returns address.**	Do not print it in captions.	Section 1

#	Decision	Recommendation	Evidence
16	**Approver and who runs the account.**	Hermanus Kriel approves. Name one person for the account.	Workbook A
17	**Block auto-release for Bag Drop** until it has its own Postiz key and a configured account.	Yes	Section 17 and the wiki publish-path page

0. Document control

Field	Value	Status
Brand	The Bag Drop	CONFIRMED (workbook A, site)
Bible version	Template v1, Bag Drop draft 1, 2026-10-13	DRAFT
Owner (writes and maintains)	Christelle (marketing)	DRAFT
Approver (signs changes)	Hermanus Kriel (Stick Golf Group)	CONFIRMED as brand owner (workbook A); approval role DRAFT
Next review	2027-01-13, and after any rebrand	DRAFT
Sources	See header	CONFIRMED

Section status: 0 to 3 DRAFT · 4 CONFIRMED (from the workbook's record of the strategy) · 5 DRAFT · 6 DRAFT · 7 mixed, row by row · 8 DRAFT · 9 DRAFT · 10 DRAFT · 11 DRAFT, nothing confirmed · 12 and 13 CONFIRMED (workbook G, H) · 14 DRAFT · 15 DRAFT · 16 CONFIRMED (counted) · 17 DRAFT.

1. Snapshot

Field	Value	Status
Trading name	The Bag Drop	DRAFT (decision 2)
Website	thebagdrop.co.za (a Shopify store). **Not** bagdrop.co.za, which is an unrelated luggage storage company	CONFIRMED (workbook S; store observed 2026-10-13)
What it is, literally	A curated South African golf gear store: demo heads, pre-owned clubs, putters, shafts and the essentials (balls, gloves, grips, towels). "Not a marketplace; an edited drop."	CONFIRMED (workbook A, site)
What it is not	Not a bargain bin. Not a giant marketplace. Not Facebook Marketplace. Not a lifestyle brand. Not a bag-storage service	CONFIRMED (workbook C, G); last item see decision 1
Market	South Africa, online, national shipping. Audience is national: Johannesburg, Cape Town, Pretoria, Durban	CONFIRMED (workbook B)
Returns address	Olivewood Estate, 50 Christo Avenue, Olivedale, Randburg, 2188. This is where returns are sent. It is not a shop to visit	CONFIRMED (refund policy). Do not publish (decision 15)
Email	hello@thebagdrop.co.za	CONFIRMED (refund policy, 2026-10-13)
Phone, WhatsApp, opening hours		UNKNOWN. The strategy mentions WhatsApp for alerts. Nothing on the site

Field	Value	Status
Customer actions	Shop. Enquire. Check before buying new. Join Drop Alerts	**CONFIRMED** (workbook A). Drop Alerts: decision 11
Instagram	`the_bagdrop_za` , 183 followers, 33 posts	**CONFIRMED** (Graph lookup, 2026-10-13)
Facebook	Page "The Bag Drop" (`facebook.com/people/The-Bag-Drop/61590637170718/`)	**CONFIRMED** (site footer)
TikTok	`@the.bag.drop.southafrica` . Not a priority (workbook O)	**CONFIRMED** (site footer)
Owner	Hermanus Kriel, Stick Golf Group	**CONFIRMED** (workbook A)
Relationship to Swing Shack and Stick	Part of the same group's fitting ecosystem. Stands on its own identity (workbook S asks for the independence to be clarified)	**CONFIRMED** (strategy)

2. Language settings

Setting	Decision	Feed evidence	Status
Language variant (L1.1)	South African English, British spelling	All 33 captions	**DRAFT**
Serial comma (L2.7)	No		**DRAFT**
Quotation marks	Double, curly		**DRAFT**
Apostrophes (L2.3)	Curly	7 captions curly, 0 straight	**DRAFT**
Exclamation marks (L2.4)	0 in headlines. Max 1 per post	3 of 33 captions, all in August	**DRAFT**
Em and en dashes (L2.2)	Never	0	**CONFIRMED** rule
Ellipsis (L2.5)	Never	0	**CONFIRMED**
Number style (L3.1)	Numerals for data, specs and money		**DRAFT**
Currency (L3.2)	`R6,500` . Always the R and the comma. Never `R5000` , `R8 500`	Feed uses four formats	**DRAFT** (decision 6)
Price shown	Always, on every product post (workbook K). A price is the point of a drop	4 of 33 captions show a price	**DRAFT**
Specs	`Loft: 11°. Condition: B. Price: R5,000.` Each on its own, with a degree sign and full stops	Feed runs them together: `Loft: 11 Condition: Demo Price: R5000`	**DRAFT**
Units (L3.3)	Metres for distance, degrees for loft		**DRAFT**
Dates (L3.4)	`30 July` . No ordinals		**DRAFT**
Hook maximum (L5.1)	80 characters	Median first line not measured (captions run 10 to 44 words)	**DRAFT**
Hashtags (L5.8)	0 to 3, last, CamelCase	0 of 33 captions use any	**DRAFT**

Setting	Decision	Feed evidence	Status
Allowed hashtags	`#TheBagDrop` `#DemoGolf` `#PreOwnedGolf` `#GolfGearSA`	New	DRAFT
Emoji (L5.9)	Max 1, with a job: 📦 on OUT THE DOOR, 🔍 on CONDITION CHECK, ⛳ on THE DROP. A space before it	0 in June. 13 of 13 July and 4 of 4 August captions use them, one after almost every line, and often with no space (`DM` ⛳)	DRAFT. Workbook D: "Selective and intentional... Never gratuitous"
Caps	Sentence case. Headlines on images: no full stop		DRAFT
Sign-off (L5.7)	None		DRAFT
Links in captions	`Link in bio`. Instagram captions cannot carry a live link, so a pasted `www.` address is not clickable	6 captions paste the address, 2 say "link in bio"	DRAFT
Contact line	One CTA line, section 6		DRAFT

3. Name registry

Name	Write it as	Known wrong forms (seen in the feed or workbook)	Notes
This brand	`The Bag Drop`, then `Bag Drop`	`Bagdrop`, `BagDrop` (except in the web address), `Bag drop`	The logo and site title read "BagDrop" (decision 2)
Web address	`thebagdrop.co.za`	`bagdrop.co.za` (a different company), `www.thebagdrop.co.za` pasted into captions	A wrong domain is a hard fail
Instagram handle	`@the_bagdrop_za`	`@bagdrop`, `@thebagdrop`	
Sister brands	`Swing Shack`, `Stick`	`SwingShack`, `Stick.paarl` used as a name	Only with approver sign-off (decision 8)
Hero products	Callaway Ai Smoke (Triple Diamond, Max D), Srixon ZX 5, Mizuno (STZ, STX, STG, ST Max), TaylorMade (Qi35, Qi10, TP-Soto 1, TP-Reserve B11), Odyssey Ai-One, Ping (Anser 2D, DS72), Scotty Cameron Square Back 2, Titleist (Vokey SM 10, T250U, U505), Cleveland RTX 6, Cobra		Copy the model name from the product page exactly. `Ai-ONE` and `Ai-One`, `Tiple` and `Triple` appear
Shafts and grips	MCA (Vanquish, Eldio), KBS, HZRDUS, Fujikura, Accra, GripDrip, Golf Pride, Zen Swing Grip		Spell as the listing does
Other makers on the store	Titleist, Callaway, Cobra, TaylorMade, Srixon, Mizuno, Odyssey, Ping, Cleveland, FootJoy, Pure	`Taylormade` (also on the site)	Check a listing before naming a brand
Terms	`demo head`, `demo club`, `pre-owned`, `full club`, `head only`, `the drop`, `condition grade`	`second-hand`, `pre-loved`, `used` (except policy), `bargain`	One term per thing
Properties	`THE DROP`, `CONDITION CHECK`, `WHO THIS SUITS`, `OUT THE DOOR`, `SMALL WINS`, `WANTED`		Section 8. As on-image titles, not in captions

4. Strategy core

All `CONFIRMED` from the workbook's record of the strategy v2, unless noted.

- **Purpose.** To change how South African golfers think about pre-owned and demo gear, and to make "check Bag Drop before buying new" a habit, by removing the embarrassment, uncertainty and risk around second-hand equipment.
- **Core belief.** Good gear doesn't need to be new.
- **Promise.** Great golf gear, ready for another round.
- **Mental availability goal.** "Before I buy golf gear, I check Bag Drop."
- **Positioning.** A curated South African golf gear store: demo, pre-owned and useful equipment, edited for quality and value. Honest condition grading, limited-stock drops, real SOLD proof. Every product has a reason to be there.
- **Enemy.** The assumption that buying new is always right. The embarrassment around "used". The uncertainty about condition, trust and fit. The friction of Facebook Marketplace.
- **Personality.** Sharp, honest, confident, curated, clever.
- **Primary audience.** South African golfers who know what they want and do not want to pay new prices. They know brands and specs, are comfortable shopping online, and are tired of Marketplace. Equipment nerds, club hoppers, returning golfers rebuilding a bag, value-conscious serious golfers, fitters looking for demo heads, juniors on budgets.
- **Secondary.** Golfers new to the sport or returning, and gift buyers. They need more education.
- **They already know:** demo and pre-owned gear exists, the big brands are good, new clubs are expensive. Do not explain what a demo club is.
- **They worry that:** "demo" means beaten up, the condition will not match the photos, the spec will be wrong, returns will be painful, shipping will cost more than they save, "curated" means overpriced, the club will sell before they decide.
- **Never make them feel:** they are buying someone else's junk, ashamed of buying pre-owned, sold to, confused about condition, that the deal is too good to be true.
- **Commercial lanes.** Hero finds (demo drivers, woods, putters), smart upgrades (wedges, shafts, single clubs), easy first purchase (balls, gloves, grips, towels), bag builders (bundles).
- **Seasonal.** Pre-season (January to March): "New season, smart start." Winter (May to August): wedge refresh, grips, balls. Gift season (November to December): putters, balls, gloves. Year-round: a drop every week.
- **Group link.** Sits inside the Stick Golf Group's fitting ecosystem (Swing Shack fitting, Stick workshop).

5. Voice

5.1 Character

- **Voice in five words:** sharp, honest, confident, curated, clever. `CONFIRMED` (workbook D).
- **How that sounds when it works:** dry and plain. The humour is the satisfaction of a good find, never slapstick and never self-deprecating.
- **If The Bag Drop were a person:** the friend who knows exactly which shelf the good stuff is on, tells you honestly what condition it is in, and does not oversell it.
- **Point of view:** a good club does not stop being good because someone has hit it before.
- **We are, but not:**
  - honest, but not blunt: we show the wear, we do not apologise for it.
  - curated, but not precious: edited, not exclusive.
  - confident, but not loud: "Available now" over "ACT NOW".
  - dry, but not sarcastic: the reader is in on it.

- good value, never "cheap".

5.2 Voice dials

Dial	Setting	The rule that follows
Formality	2 of 5	Plain and direct. No text-speak
Humour	3 of 5	One dry line per post at most. Never about the reader's gear or money
Boldness	3 of 5	Say what it is and what it costs. No hype
Technicality	3 of 5	Loft, flex, length, condition grade, with the number set in the spec line. Light on accessories
Warmth	3 of 5	Friendly, not gushing
Energy	2 of 5	Calm. No exclamation marks. No shouting
Local flavour	3 of 5	The rand, South African places and idiom, used lightly ("priced in rand. You know what that means")

5.3 Tone shifts by situation

Situation	Tone	Length	Humour?	Example opening line (* marks an illustration, not a feed line)
THE DROP (new stock)	Product-first, price and condition lead	15 to 30 words	A dry line if it earns it	`Callaway Ai Smoke Triple Diamond driver head.` *
CONDITION CHECK	Plain, evidence-led, show the wear	20 to 40 words	None	`Face, sole, crown. This is the actual head.` *
WHO THIS SUITS	Problem first	25 to 45 words	Yes	`The hardest club to fit in your bag is the 3-wood.`
SMALL WINS	Problem first, useful	15 to 30 words	Yes	`Old balls do old-ball things.`
OUT THE DOOR	Short proof	10 to 20 words	Light	`Gone. Packed. On its way to Pretoria.` *
WANTED	Invitation	15 to 30 words	Light	`Looking for a driver under R5,000? Tell us.` *
Offer	Understated, complete	15 to 30 words	None	What, who, until when, how
Bad news (out of stock, delay)	Plain, quick	10 to 25 words	None	`That one has sold. Here is what is similar.` *
Reply to a question	Specific, quick	5 to 30 words	Match theirs	Answer first, then the price, then the link
Reply to a complaint	Calm, specific, private	15 to 40 words	None	`Sorry about that. Can you email hello@thebagdrop.co.za with your order number so we can sort it?` *

5.4 Humour, slang and sensitive ground

- **Humour that works (from the feed and site):** "the days when the water hazard starts collecting rent" · "Old balls do old-ball things" · "No fuss. No mystery listings. No overpaying for the sake of it." · and from the refund policy: "Golf clubs do not enjoy being treated like loose biltong in a box."
- **Never:** hype ("looking absolutely lethal", "murdered-out", "Don't sleep on this one", "Grab it before it's gone!"), violent idiom, "aggressively", engagement bait ("Drop what you've got in the comments"), false scarcity.

- **Slang allowed (workbook D):** `stripe it` , `gapping` , `setup` , `drop` , `score` , `find` . **Never:** `G.O.A.T.` , `beast` , `lit` .
- **Profanity:** none.
- **Never joke about:** a customer's budget, a golfer's ability or the golfer for buying pre-owned. "Dusty gear" is borderline. Prefer "clubs you no longer swing".

6. Lexicon

Signature lines

Line	Where it goes
`Good gear doesn't need to be new.`	The belief. Education and brand posts
`Great golf gear, ready for another round.`	The consumer promise (strategy). Bio, site, brand pieces
`Already been hit. Still got it.`	Strategy line for pre-owned posts
`This just dropped.`	THE DROP
`Missed the last one? Here's the next.`	After a sold-out drop
`Actual item. Actual condition.`	CONDITION CHECK
`Shop the drop.`	Bio and CTA

Approved calls to action (L5.6)

One per caption. The "how" is part of the CTA.

CTA	Use for	Status
`Shop the drop. Link in bio.`	THE DROP	DRAFT
`View the product. Link in bio.`	A single product	DRAFT
`Message us to order.`	One-off or limited items	DRAFT (workbook list)
`Tell us what you are after.`	WANTED	DRAFT
`Shop putters. Link in bio.`	A category (also `Shop balls. Link in bio.` and so on)	DRAFT
`Join Drop Alerts.`	Only once a sign-up exists	UNKNOWN (decision 11)
`Email hello@thebagdrop.co.za.`	Returns and order questions	CONFIRMED

Banned for The Bag Drop (adds to L7)

Phrase	Why
`second-hand` , `pre-loved` , `bargain` , `steal` , `cheap` , `as-is`	Workbook D lists each as devaluing or vague
`Like new condition` , `mint condition`	"Prove it, don't claim it." Use a grade with evidence (workbook D)
`inspected` , `tested`	Process claims with no recorded process (Proof bank)
`DM for price` , `Message us for current stock` as the whole CTA	Hides the value. Workbook K: never make the customer ask

Phrase	Why
`Don't sleep on this one` , `Grab it before it's gone` , `Stock moves fast` , `Good clubs move quickly`	Hype and unproven scarcity
`lethal` , `murdered-out` , `stealth mode` , `aggressively`	Hype, violent idiom
`Score the deal of a lifetime`	Hype (workbook D)
`Drop what you've got in the comments`	Engagement bait
`One careful owner` , `non-smoker` , `always garaged` , `lady golfer`	Car-sales language, patronising (workbook D)
`bagdrop.co.za`	The wrong domain
`Thursday social` , `member social` , `drop your bag` , `Join the family`	The old repo description, not this store (decision 1)

Watch words (max one per caption)

`premium` , `proper` , `clean` , `serious` , `sharp` , `smart` .

Say this, not that

Say this	Not that	Why
`Callaway Ai Smoke Triple Diamond driver head. Loft: 11°. Condition: B. Price: R5,000.` (an illustration, the grade is a placeholder)	`Demo driver head Loft: 11 Condition: Demo Price: R5000`	Complete, correct, readable
`Condition: A. Face wear is light. Photos below.`	`Mint condition`	Evidence, not a claim
`Pre-owned and demo clubs.`	`Second-hand finds`	Workbook D
`Shop the drop. Link in bio.`	`Message us for current stock.`	Tells the reader where to go
`Demo heads, in stock now.`	`Stock moves fast.`	True without implying pressure
`R6,500`	`R 6,500.00` , `R6500` , `R 6 500`	One format

7. Messaging and the Proof bank

Master message

Bag Drop is where South African golfers check before buying new, because good gear doesn't need to be new, and a good find is worth coming back for. `CONFIRMED` (workbook E).

Supporting messages, ranked

1. Good gear doesn't need to be new.
2. Honest condition: transparent grading, real photography, what you see is what you get.
3. Curated, not endless: someone decided every product is worth listing.
4. Stock changes: the drop gives a reason to check back. If it is gone, it is gone.
5. Connected to real golf: inside the Stick Golf Group with fitters and coaches.

Proof bank

`CONFIRMED` rows can be used. `DRAFT` rows need a check on the day. `UNKNOWN` means silence.

Fact (as it may be written)	Value	Source	Verified	Expires	Status
Web address	thebagdrop.co.za	Site	2026-10-13	never	**CONFIRMED**
Return window	30 days after receiving the item	Refund policy	2026-10-13	re-check quarterly	**CONFIRMED**
Return conditions	Unused, in the condition received, with tags, packaging, headcovers and accessories. Proof of purchase. Email hello@thebagdrop.co.za first	Refund policy	2026-10-13	quarterly	**CONFIRMED**
Return shipping	Paid by the customer unless the item is faulty, damaged or incorrect	Refund policy	2026-10-13	quarterly	**CONFIRMED**
Refunds	To the original payment method within 10 business days of approval	Refund policy	2026-10-13	quarterly	**CONFIRMED**
Not returnable	Custom-built clubs, special orders, personalised items, installed used grips, items damaged by misuse, gift cards, clearance or final-sale items	Refund policy	2026-10-13	quarterly	**CONFIRMED**
Pre-owned and demo wear	"Normal wear, cosmetic marks, bag chatter, small scratches or other disclosed condition notes are not considered defects"	Refund policy	2026-10-13	quarterly	**CONFIRMED**
Products listed	144 products. Condition option on 71 (A 53, B 19, New 3). True Loft and Specs on 62	Store product list	2026-10-13	daily	**CONFIRMED** on that date. Never quote the count later
Price range	R90 to R9,999.99	Store product list	2026-10-13	daily	**CONFIRMED** on that date
Categories	Full clubs, demo heads, demo clubs, drivers, fairway woods, hybrids, putters, wedges, shafts, grips, balls, gloves, towels	Site	2026-10-13	monthly	**CONFIRMED**
A specific product and price	e.g. Callaway Ai Smoke Triple Diamond driver, full club, R6,500 (home page, 2026-10-13)	Site		per post	**DRAFT**. Check the listing on the day
Condition grades A and B	Defined as				**UNKNOWN**. The owners must write the definitions
"Inspected, tested, listed in the condition we promise"		Feed 18 Jul			**UNKNOWN**. No process is recorded
"Mint condition" on demo heads		Feed 15 and 21 Jul			**UNKNOWN**. Not on the grade scale
Shipping rates and times					**UNKNOWN**. No page. "National shipping" is in the strategy
Free shipping until 30 July 2026		Feed 22 Jun		expired	**EXPIRED**
`R500 off a fitting` at Swing Shack or Stick when you buy from The Bag Drop		Feed 22 and 25 Jun, 30 Jul			**UNKNOWN**. No end date, limits or claim process (decision 9)

Fact (as it may be written)	Value	Source	Verified	Expires	Status
Trade-ins		Feed 8 Aug			UNKNOWN (decision 10)
Drop Alerts (email or WhatsApp)		Strategy			UNKNOWN (decision 11)
Followers and posts	183 and 33	Graph lookup	2026-10-13	daily	CONFIRMED on that date. Internal
Opening hours, phone					UNKNOWN
Performance numbers in the strategy (GA4 sessions, cost per click, landing-page views)		Strategy			Internal. Never in public copy

Banned fabrications (workbook H): never invent pricing, specs (loft, lie, length, flex), model names, logos, condition grades, products that do not exist, SOLD proof that has not happened, or customer testimonials.

Offer register

Offer	What	Who	Ends	How to claim	Approved wording	Status
Fitting credit	R500 off a fitting at Swing Shack or Stick when you buy from The Bag Drop		UNKNOWN	UNKNOWN		UNKNOWN
Shipping	Free delivery		UNKNOWN (30 July was the last stated date)			UNKNOWN

Offers feel understated (workbook K): "Better price" over "Bargain", "Available now" over "ACT NOW". No "was and now" theatre. Scarcity only when true: "One available", "Last one". If there are several, say "stock available".

8. Caption lanes

The six lanes come from the strategy (workbook J). The feed has used only the first three in any recognisable form, so lane counts are from a keyword pass over 33 captions and are approximate.

```
LANE: THE DROP
Purpose:            The recurring stock moment: preview, live, still available, gone
Anatomy:            Product line / spec line (loft, condition, price) / one dry line / CTA
Length:             15 to 30 words (the feed's four single-product posts run 23 to 28)
Hook patterns:      "[Brand model]." / "This just dropped." / "[Category], in stock now."
CTA:                Shop the drop. Link in bio.
On-image text:      DROP stamp, price lock-up, condition badge (deterministic overlay)
Cadence:            Weekly (workbook J). Primary content engine
Approved example:   See section 15, golden 3
Rejected example:   "The Mizuno STG driver head is seriously underrated..." (hype, no price)
Notes:              Price in every drop. One spec line. Never "DM for price"

LANE: CONDITION CHECK
Purpose:            Trust: actual item, actual condition
Anatomy:            Item / grade / what wear is visible / what is included / CTA
Length:             20 to 40 words
CTA:                View the product. Link in bio.
Cadence:            At least one per drop, and every listing
Notes:              Needs 4 to 6 real photos (face, sole, crown, shaft, grip). The store's median product has 1.
Photography is the blocker, not the writing

LANE: WHO THIS SUITS
Purpose:            Connect one product to one golfer's problem
Anatomy:            The problem / the product / who it suits / CTA
Length:             25 to 45 words
CTA:                View the product. Link in bio.
Approved example:   7 Aug "The hardest club to fit in your bag is the 3-wood." (trim the emoji)
Cadence:            At least one per drop cycle

LANE: SMALL WINS
Purpose:            Low-friction entry: grips, balls, gloves, towels
Anatomy:            A true small problem / the fix / price / CTA
Length:             15 to 30 words
Approved example:   16 and 17 July "Old wedges cost shots", "Old balls do old-ball things"
Cadence:            Weekly. The feed already does this well

LANE: OUT THE DOOR
Purpose:            Proof that stock moves
Anatomy:            What went / "Missed it?" / CTA
Length:             10 to 20 words
CTA:                Join Drop Alerts (when it exists), or Shop similar. Link in bio.
Cadence:            Every sale that can be photographed
Notes:              The feed has none. Real sales only. Consent for any person or label shown

LANE: WANTED
Purpose:            Demand capture and sourcing
Anatomy:            "Looking for [category] under R[x]?" / how to tell us
Length:             15 to 30 words
Cadence:            Twice a month

LANE: Stock overview and category (the feed's main lane in June)
Purpose:            Say what the store sells
Notes:              16 June captions did this: "Bag Drop stocks demo clubs, second-hand clubs and useful
essentials..." with "Message us for current stock". Too generic (workbook: "looks like any golf gear resale
account"). Fold into THE DROP, with a product and a price

LANE: Offers (cross-offer, shipping)
Notes:              Section 7. Terms complete before it runs
```

9. Channel rules

Workbook L. `DRAFT`.

Channel	Role	Formats	Length	Hashtags	CTA	Avoid
Instagram feed	Product showcase and trust. Home of THE DROP, CONDITION CHECK, WHO THIS SUITS	Carousel (product detail), static hero shot, Reel cross-posts	Per lane	0 to 3	Shop, View product, Enquire	Catalogue posts with no reason to care. Low-quality product photos
Instagram Stories	Fast texture: drops, SOLD alerts, polls ("What should we source?")	Stories-native	1 to 2 lines	None	DM, Shop, Join alerts	Clutter. More than 5 slides per topic
Reels	Engagement and proof: condition close-ups, OUT THE DOOR, drop reveals	9:16. Fast cuts for reveals, slow close-ups for condition	Caption per lane	0 to 3	Shop, View product	No branded frame. Talking head with no product. Silent with no text overlay
Facebook	Product drops and retargeting. Audience skews older, more purchase-ready	Feed, Reel cross-posts	Per lane	None	Shop, Message	Cross-posts with no context
Paid ads	Conversion engine	Product sales, category sales, retargeting, Drop Alert sign-up, SMALL WINS	Per brief	None	Shop, View product	Celebrating cheap clicks with no purchase measure. Note: Christelle's rule is that ad creative is real human video (project memory); the exception is an animated still of a retail product
Website	Conversion and trust destination	Product pages with grade, multi-angle photos, returns cues, Who this suits copy	Per page	n/a	Add to cart, Enquire	Pages with no condition grade, no UTM tracking, no similar items when a product sells
Google Business Profile	Low priority: online-first	Posts, photos of recent stock	1 to 3 sentences	None	Visit, Call, Message	Inconsistent posting
TikTok	Not a priority					

10. Customer conversation

- **Who replies:** UNKNOWN. Name one person.
- **Speed:** within a working day. `DRAFT`.
- **Price questions:** answer with the price and the link in the first line. Never "DM for price".
- **Condition questions:** answer with the grade, the wear and a photo. If there is no photo, say it will be added.
- **Returns and order issues:** point to hello@thebagdrop.co.za with the order number. State the 30-day policy plainly.
- **Complaints:** acknowledge, take it to email, fix it, never argue in public.
- **Escalate to the owner:** a dispute over condition, a refund refused, a legal threat, press, an injury, anything about a named person.
- **Reply examples:** section 5.3.

11. Visual identity

Colours and fonts are unconfirmed and three sources disagree. Do not recolour from this table. See `CampaignOS/decisions/everything-runs-through-brand-bibles-2026-10-12.md` in the wiki. Workbook S itself says "TO CONFIRM: colour HEX values are inferred".

Element	Repo files say	Workbook F says	The live site shows (2026-10-13)
Primary	Warm orange `#F4A261`, deep teal-navy `#264653`	Charcoal `#121212`, off-white `#F5F3ED`	A light page. White `#FFFFFF`, a warm off-white hero. Body text sage green `#607055`. Navy headings and logo. The theme also defines navy `#002B5B`, gold `#FFD700`, cream `#F5F0D6`, burgundy `#3D000A` colour schemes, and a primary of `#253F59`
Accent		Lime `#C9EF62` (sale markers), amber `#F2A541` (SOLD, CTAs)	Sage green buttons
Fonts	Not pinned	Inter, JetBrains Mono for grades and specs	Montserrat. Headings at weight 900, body at 400
Logo	`bag-drop/logo.png` (not checked)	"Upload actual logo assets"	A "BD" mark with the wordmark "BAGDROP", in the site header, as an SVG
Feel	"Warm", "community", "candid member moments"	"Clean, sharp, minimal. Not warm/fuzzy"	Light, clean, uncluttered

The strategy and the live site agree on "clean, uncluttered". They disagree on dark against light. Decision 4.

- **Layout (workbook F):** product-centred, 60 to 70% of frame. Logo top-left on feed, top-right on Stories. DROP stamp or SOLD overlay in the top or bottom third, never covering the product face. Text outside the product frame.
- **Devices (workbook F):** THE DROP stamp, a diagonal SOLD overlay, a condition grade badge, a price lock-up, an OUT THE DOOR frame (parcel, text, "Missed it? Join Drop Alerts").

12. Photography and imagery

`CONFIRMED` from workbook G, N and Q.

- **Look:** clean, sharp, honest. High-contrast product photography on a dark or neutral background. Lighting makes condition visible. Neutral colour temperature. No warm or golden cast. Accuracy over mood.
- **Product first.** Most content has no people. When a person appears: hands holding a club for scale, the next customer, a fitter pointing out condition. No stock-model smiles.
- **Location:** a clean photography space. Never a golf course, a country club, outdoor grass, a cluttered workshop, or fake luxury (marble, satin, gold).
- **Condition must be visible.** Face wear, sole marks and shaft rub are shown, not hidden or retouched. A graded item is never made to look better than it is.
- **Real over generated:** never render a product, a venue or a SOLD proof. The workbook's acceptance test rejects any image where the product does not match the real item, the condition is hidden, text is generated, or the background is a course.
- **Today:** 89 of 144 products have one photo and 15 have none (2026-10-13).

13. Product and asset fidelity

`CONFIRMED` (workbook H). Preserved exactly: model markings, sole branding, finish, cavity geometry, weighting ports, shaft graphics and flex marking, grip pattern, putter neck style, handedness, packaging, and the real wear. The model may change only the background, the lighting direction, the crop and the shadow. It may never invent specs, colours, model names, prices, logos, grades, products that do not exist, SOLD proof or testimonials.

14. Templates and deterministic layers

- **No measured templates exist for The Bag Drop.** There is no `templates/` folder, so `/render-post` cannot render it. `visual-spec/archetypes.json` and `palette/brand.json` exist but describe the old orange identity and should not be trusted.
- **No brand images are ingested.** The repo holds none for Bag Drop. The product photography lives in the store.
- **Needed first:** a DROP product post, a CONDITION CHECK carousel frame, a SOLD overlay and an OUT THE DOOR frame, each measured from real reference posts with `campaign-os-template`.
- Logo, price, product name, CTA and SOLD stamps are added by the deterministic layer, never typed by an image model (workbook I).
- Write copy under a template's declared limit, not at it.

15. Reference library

Golden examples

Real captions, with the fixes needed to bring them into line noted.

#	Date, lane	Caption	Why it works	Fix needed
1	17 Jul, Small wins	`Old balls do old-ball things. / Scuffs, damaged covers and tired dimples can cost distance, spin and feel.`	A dry hook and a true, useful reason	Remove the emoji, add a price and a link
2	16 Jul, Small wins	`Old wedges cost shots. / Fresh grooves give you more control where it matters most. / Check the current wedge stock.`	Problem first, one idea	Add a price and a link
3	22 Jul, The Drop	`Callaway Ai Smoke Triple Diamond demo driver head. / Loft: 11 Condition: Demo Price: R5000 / Low-spin driver head.`	The right ingredients: model, loft, condition, price	Rewrite: `Callaway Ai Smoke Triple Diamond driver head. / Loft: 11°. Condition: [grade]. Price: R5,000. / Low-spin. / Shop the drop. Link in bio.`
4	6 Jun, Category	`Running low on golf balls? / Bag Drop stocks balls for the range, the course and the days when the water hazard starts collecting rent.`	A line only a golf store could write	Add a price range and a link
5	24 Jun, Category	`Putters are personal. / Shop putters on The Bag Drop.`	Four words of belief, one CTA	Add `Link in bio`
6	7 Aug, Who this suits	`The hardest club to fit in your bag is the 3-wood. Buying off the rack rarely works. Stop guessing and fix your gaps with our demo fairway metals and hybrid heads.`	Problem first, specific	Trim the emoji, add a price, say "link in bio". Note: close to lines on Swing Shack's and Stick's feeds about "off the rack" (section 17)
7	Refund policy	`Golf clubs do not enjoy being treated like loose biltong in a box.`	The voice on its home page: dry, local, useful	None. It is the tone to copy

Rejected examples

#	Date	Caption (shortened)	Rules broken	The fix
1	6 Aug	`The Mizuno STG driver head is seriously underrated and packs a massive punch 💥 Maximum adjustability and pure ball speed. Don't sleep on this one. Grab it before it's gone! 🚀 Link in bio.`	Hype (L7), false scarcity (L4), emoji, no price, no condition, unverified claim	`Mizuno STG driver head. Loft: [x]°. Condition: [grade]. Price: [R]. Shop the drop. Link in bio.`
2	8 Aug	`Still holding onto clubs you haven't swung in two years? Let's chat 💬 We are aggressively taking trade-ins ... Drop what you've got in the comments! 👇`	A service with no terms (decision 10), engagement bait, "aggressively", emoji	Do not run until trade-ins are confirmed
3	9 Aug	`Stealth mode activated 🥷 The all-black Ping Anser 2D is looking absolutely lethal. ... murdered-out finish. Sitting in the vault ... Hit the link in our bio to make it yours!`	Violent idiom, hype, no price, no condition	`Ping Anser 2D, black finish. Condition: [grade]. Price: R5,999. Shop the drop. Link in bio.`
4	15 Jul	`Demo head does not mean damaged 💥 These heads are inspected, checked and in mint condition before they go up for sale.`	"Mint" claim and an unrecorded process (L4.1), emoji. The hook is good	`Demo head does not mean damaged. Every head is graded A or B, with photos of the face, sole and crown.` (only if true)
5	5 Jun	`Bag Drop stocks demo clubs, second-hand clubs and useful golf essentials at better price points. Smart gear. Better value. Ready to play. Message us to check what's available.`	`second-hand` (decision 7), no product, no price, a DM CTA, generic. It passes the swap test for any golf resale account (workbook M)	Lead with one product and its price
6	22 Jun	`Buy from The Bag Drop and get R500 off a fitting at SwingShack or Stick.paarl / Shop now: www.thebagdrop.co.za`	Offer terms missing (L4.3), names misspelt (L1.2), a pasted address that cannot be clicked, cross-brand mention without sign-off	Section 7 offer register, then plain wording
7	20 and 22 Jul	`Odyssey Ai-ONE Seven T putter. Condition: New Price: R8 500` · `Loft: 11 Condition: Demo Price: R5000`	Fields run together, price format (L3.2), "New" in a pre-owned store, "Demo" is not a grade, no degree sign	Section 6 say-this table
8	30 Jul	`Specials @ Bagdrop 🥏 Free delivery & R500 off a fitting at our partner facilities 🏌 Take advantage while the specials last ⛳`	No end date or terms (L4.3), "while the specials last" is false urgency, `&` in prose, three emoji, wrong name spelling	State the offer and its end date
9	14 Jul	`Bag Drop is live ⛳ ... Stock moves fast. Visit the online store or DM 🏌`	A second "we are live" after `The Bag Drop is live` on 23 June, "moves fast" is unproven	Say what is new this week
10	5 to 8 Jun	Eleven captions that end on `Message us for current stock` or `Message us to check what's available`	A CTA that gives no information. The strategy: "Never make the customer DM to ask"	A product, a price and a link

16. Feed truth and reconciliation

Counted 2026-10-13 from `feedback/instagram-audit.json` : 33 posts (20 videos, 13 images), 5 June to 9 August 2026, 183 followers. Collected from the public account, so there are no insights (reach, saves, shares). Likes average 4.5 (maximum 13). 6 comments in total.

Question	The strategy says	The feed shows	Decision
What the brand is	An online store for demo and pre-owned gear	Matches. No caption mentions a Thursday social, members or dropping a bag	The repo files are wrong (decision 1)
Voice	Sharp, honest, confident, curated, clever. Dry	The first week (5 to 8 June) is dry and plain. July adds an emoji to nearly every line. August turns to hype ("lethal", "Don't sleep on this one")	The June voice (decision 13)
Emoji	"Selective and intentional"	0 in June, then 17 of 33 captions overall, almost all in July and August	Section 2
Price	"Always visible. Never DM to ask"	4 of 33 captions state a product price. 11 of 16 June captions say "Message us"	Show price on every drop
Condition	A/B grade with photos of face, sole, crown, shaft, grip	Captions use `Demo`, `New`, `B` and "mint". The site has A 53, B 19, New 3. Median 1 photo	Decision 5
Word choice	"Pre-owned" and "demo", never "second-hand"	`second-hand` in 8 captions, `pre-owned` in 0, `demo` in 16	Decision 7
Properties	THE DROP, CONDITION CHECK, WHO THIS SUITS, OUT THE DOOR, SMALL WINS, WANTED	None is named. "Shop the drop" appears in 1 caption (23 June) and "Shop now" in 2 (22 June). No SOLD or OUT THE DOOR content	Section 8
Call to action	Shop the drop, View product, Add to cart, Join Drop Alerts, Message to order	Message us (11), DM (13), Visit the online store (12), Link in bio (2), a pasted address (6)	Section 6
Hashtags		0 of 33	Keep to 0 to 3
Scarcity	"Never create false scarcity"	"Good clubs move quickly", "Stock moves fast", "before it's gone". No SOLD proof is shown anywhere	Retire
Cross-promotion	Part of the group's fitting ecosystem	3 captions offer R500 off a fitting at Swing Shack or Stick	Decision 8
Contradictions inside the old files		README: "sub-brand of Swing Shack", `knowledge.json`: "operated by swing-shack". Workbook: "Bag Drop's independence vs group branding should be clarified". `tone-rules.md`: "community-first". Workbook: "sharp". README colours: warm orange. Workbook: "not warm/fuzzy"	This bible supersedes the old files once confirmed
Cadence	A drop every week	33 posts in 9 weeks, then nothing since 9 August	Decide who runs it
Name spelling	`Bag Drop`	`The Bag Drop` in 4 captions, `Bagdrop` in 1, `SwingShack`, `Stick.paarl`	Section 3

The feed's three phases. 5 to 8 June: eleven near-identical product-category statements, each ending "Message us". 22 to 30 June: two offers and the first videos. 14 to 30 July: videos with an emoji after almost every line, a few good problem-first captions, and the first captions with a price. 6 to 9 August: a hype voice.

17. Governance

- **Change process:** propose in the wiki or a pull request, the approver says yes in the current message, the change is logged below.
- **Who may publish without review:** SMALL WINS and THE DROP posts that pass the Gate with no hard fails and 12 or more of 16, where the price, the grade and every spec are `CONFIRMED` against the live listing on the day. Offers, trade-ins, cross-brand mentions and anything naming a person need approver review.

- **Publishing readiness:** the account is not configured in the repo and has no Postiz key. Until it has both, Bag Drop should be excluded from auto-release. The wiki page `publish-path-timing-and-risks-2026-10-12.md` explains why a post could otherwise go out through Stick's channel.
- **Across the three brands:** the Gate's swap test is run three ways: a competitor's name, and each sister brand's. Swing Shack and Stick already shared product copy in May to August 2026, and the Bag Drop caption "Buying off the rack rarely works" echoes lines used by both. Product lines never repeat across brands within 90 days.
- **Where this is the source of truth:** copy rules, names, facts and lanes. Where it disagrees with `README.md`, `voice/`, `copy/`, `knowledge.json` or `bible-visual.json`, this wins once confirmed, and those files should be regenerated from it.
- **Upstream sources:** the owners' strategy v2 and the live store. If they change, this file changes. The store's catalogue changes daily, so no count or price in this file is a fact tomorrow.

Change log

Date	Section	Change	Approved by
2026-10-13	all	First draft from the template. First Bag Drop feed audit. The repo's description found to be a different business	pending

Open questions

Question	Owner	By
Decisions 1 to 17 at the top	Christelle, then Hermanus Kriel	
Does any bag-storage service exist, and where did the old description come from?	Hermanus Kriel, Kyle	
Colours, fonts, logo files	Christelle, designer	
What do condition grades A and B mean?	Owners	
Shipping rates, trade-ins, the R500 fitting credit, Drop Alerts	Owners	
Who runs the Instagram account, and when does it restart?	Christelle	
Photography: 4 to 6 real photos per product	Owners	
Phone, WhatsApp, hours	Christelle	